Rules, Standards, and Rubrics: What Two Legal AI Benchmarks Reward

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Abstract

Two public benchmarks now grade AI-drafted legal work against rubrics written by lawyers: Harvey's Legal Agent Benchmark (LAB) and micro1's LegalReasonBench. I audited the litigation portions of both public releases. AI auditors screened every criterion (2,858 in LAB's 52 litigation tasks; 179 in LegalReasonBench's 11 litigation assignments), and I reviewed a random sample of 25 flagged criteria from each benchmark under a protocol fixed before the draw. In LAB, 16 of 25 sampled criteria were defective, 9 of them objective errors in which the record, the law, or the arithmetic contradicts the rubric. In LegalReasonBench, 21 of 25 were defective, 7 of them objective. Within the flagged sets, at least 383 LAB criteria (13.4% of all litigation criteria) and at least 45 LegalReasonBench criteria (25.1%) are defective at 95% confidence.

The defects come in two kinds. Some criteria get a question with one right answer wrong: they penalize a brief for quoting the opponent's statistic in order to rebut it, credit a brief for asserting that affidavits exist when none were supplied, or award points for finding a date conflict that the record does not contain. Others take a question that admits several defensible answers and make one lawyer's choice mandatory. That distinction is one lawyers already use, as the line between rules and standards and between de novo and abuse-of-discretion review, and I argue it is the right frame for building and auditing legal rubrics. Current rubrics get both halves wrong often enough that scores on these benchmarks, and training gains measured against them, cannot yet be read as measures of professional judgment. The paper reports both audits, the native grading of two frontier models on the same tasks, citation checks of the task environments, and the complete human review.

1 Introduction

One of LegalReasonBench's litigation assignments asks the model to draft a brief opposing a motion to transfer a medical-negligence case out of Cook County. The defendants' main congestion argument is a statistic: Cook County's 60.5% clearance rate, taken from an Illinois court report that the task supplies. Claude Opus 5.5 answered that argument the way a litigator would. Under the heading "Defendants rely on the wrong statistic," it stated the defendants' figure, explained that the figure pools criminal, traffic, family, and juvenile matters with civil cases, and supplied the civil-case rates that matter: 97.9% for Cook County and 96.3% for the proposed forum. The rubric contains a penalty criterion that deducts 30 points if the brief "states" that the report shows a 60.5% clearance rate. All three of the benchmark's AI judges applied it, and the same brief earned credit on two neighboring criteria for citing the civil rates. On the saved run, that one penalty took the assignment score from 86% to 45%.

Nothing about that grade is a judging error. The judges did exactly what the criterion says. The problem is the criterion, which treats stating a proposition as endorsing it. A brief that cannot name the other side's number cannot rebut it. This paper is about criteria of that kind, and about a second kind that is harder to see.

Whether a grader applies a criterion consistently is a different question from whether the criterion rewards good legal work. Both benchmarks have invested in the first question. LAB grades every criterion with two frontier models; LegalReasonBench uses a three-judge panel and a strict majority; Harvey has published work on how closely its model judges track lawyer preferences [10]. None of that answers the second question. Three judges can agree that a brief triggers a penalty while the penalty itself is wrong.

To get at the second question, I audited the litigation portions of both public releases. I am a litigator with eighteen years of practice, and litigation is the part of these benchmarks I can review. AI auditors screened every criterion in LAB's 52 litigation tasks and in the 11 litigation assignments of LegalReasonBench's public sample. I then reviewed a simple random sample of 25 flagged criteria from each benchmark, under a protocol committed before the draw, reading the task instructions, the supplied record, the governing law, and how each benchmark's own judges had graded two frontier models on the same criterion. Harvey had invited practicing lawyers to audit LAB's rubrics when it released them [8]; micro1 released its sample under an open license. This scrutiny is possible only because they did.

The defects sort into two kinds, and the distinction between them is one every lawyer already uses. Some questions in legal work have one right answer: what the record says, what the statute provides, what the arithmetic yields, what a court may consider on a motion to dismiss. Other questions admit a range of defensible answers: which arguments to lead with, whether a minor discrepancy belongs in a motion, whether to appeal or simply cure the defect on remand. Lawyers call the first kind rules and the second kind standards, and appellate courts review the first de novo and the second only for abuse of discretion. A rubric is a good instrument for the first kind. Applied to the second, it converts one lawyer's choice into the only acceptable answer, and a model trained against it learns that the choice was mandatory. In the audited samples, criteria of the first kind are wrong often enough to matter, and criteria of the second kind are common.

The paper makes four contributions. Section 2 and Section 3 report the two audits with their denominators, sampling frames, and confidence bounds. Section 4 develops the exhibits, organized by how the criterion goes wrong rather than by benchmark. Section 5 sets out the rules-and-standards frame and the argument that more plausible points do not make better lawyering. Sections 6 through 9 say what the published literature asks of a rubric reward, what these scores and the training gains measured against them establish, how the rubrics were made, and where I think the signal should come from instead. Appendices carry the complete human review of all 50 sampled criteria, the native grading of both benchmarks, the citation checks, and a case study of one synthetic task environment.

2 Two benchmarks and how I audited them

2.1 The benchmarks

Harvey AI Corporation, the leading vertical legal AI company, released LAB in May 2026. It is now widely cited by frontier research labs as a key evaluation of agentic legal capability. The first release has roughly 1,250 tasks across 24 practice areas and, by Harvey's count, more than 75,000

expert-written rubric criteria; Harvey says it started from real client matters handled by practicing lawyers and split them into discrete tasks; the task documents themselves are synthetic [8]. Each criterion is a binary pass or fail, and a task is marked complete only if every criterion passes. Harvey open-sourced a portion of the benchmark on GitHub and keeps a private set that Artificial Analysis uses for its leaderboard [14]. I audited the 52 tasks and 2,858 criteria in the public litigation and dispute resolution folder at Harvey commit `1dd81403`.

micro1, a data company, maintains LegalReasonBench. The full benchmark has 50 matters, 122 sequential assignments, and 2,236 criteria, of which 353 are penalty criteria; micro1 states that a practicing lawyer authored each matter, its case file, and its rubrics end to end [13]. The public sample on Hugging Face has 15 assignments and 221 criteria. Eleven of those assignments, with 179 criteria across four matters, concern an adversarial proceeding and are the litigation subset I audited: a land-use certiorari dispute, a police-discipline arbitration challenge, a criminal appeal over a jury instruction, and a forum non conveniens motion. At least three of the four are adapted from real cases with names and some facts changed. Criteria carry signed point values; a three-judge panel decides each criterion by strict majority; an assignment's score is its signed points divided by its positive points, clamped to the unit interval. The dataset is pinned at revision `1bfa904c` [5].

Two design differences matter for reading what follows. LAB's all-pass rule means one failed criterion fails the task, so a single defective criterion can zero an otherwise acceptable deliverable. LegalReasonBench's signed points mean a defective penalty costs a bounded number of points, but those penalties are large: the 60.5% penalty is 30 points against 73 available on its assignment. And LAB's records are synthetic, while much of LegalReasonBench is adapted from real litigation, which turns out to produce a different failure mode (Section 8).

2.2 AI screening and two sampling frames

I supplied GPT-6 Sol and Claude Opus 5.5 with examples of the kinds of rubrics I consider defective and asked them to work through every task and flag criteria under the high-level standard I gave them, which allowed them to raise issues not on my list. On LAB, Sol flagged 616 criteria; Opus flagged 650 blind and 564 after reading Sol's findings. Between them they flagged 835 criteria (29.2%). Because Opus saw Sol's findings before finalizing, agreement in the final reports is not independent confirmation [1]. On LegalReasonBench, both models audited blind; the union of their blind flags is 63 of 179 criteria (35.2%). A later reconciliation pass, which saw both reports, retained 36 of the 63 [5].

The two human-review frames therefore differ. The LAB frame combines Sol's flags with Opus's final, post-reconciliation position. The LegalReasonBench frame is the union of the two blind reports, retaining flags the reconciliation later withdrew. The LegalReasonBench frame is broader relative to its population and should, other things equal, contain more rejected flags. The two confirmation rates are not an apples-to-apples comparison of benchmark quality and I do not present them as one.

2.3 The standard I applied

From each frame I drew a simple random sample of 25 criteria without replacement, with a fixed seed, under a protocol committed before the draw [2, 6]. I treated a criterion as defective if, applied as written to the task as given, it would fail a response a careful litigator would consider appropriate or pass one a careful litigator would consider wrong on the issue the criterion covers. A criterion that forces one of several permissible answers is therefore defective, because it fails the others.

A demanding but defensible standard is not defective, and neither is a criterion that follows an instruction in a fictional record that misstates real-world law, so long as a response can reasonably follow it. Arguable covers cases where careful litigators could disagree about whether the failed response is appropriate.

For each defective criterion I recorded whether it rests on an unambiguous objective error (the record, the law, the cited authority, or the arithmetic contradicts the rubric) or on professional judgment, and whether the defect arises from an error in the supplied task materials rather than in the criterion alone. I separately recorded whether the task environment itself contains a defect, whether or not it touches the sampled criterion. An environment defect that does not change what a competent response can get right leaves the criterion not defective.

After an initial set of verdicts, I asked AI models (GPT-6 Sol, GPT-6 Astra, Claude Opus 5.5, and Claude Fable 5.1) to stress test them and argue both for and against each call, then did a consistency pass through the full set. A handful of LAB verdicts changed after the first stress test; the LegalReasonBench verdicts were finalized after a second, adversarial round. During that round I refined the written description of the standard to say plainly what I had been applying: that failing an answer a careful lawyer would consider correct or clearly reasonable is a defect, because such a criterion trains models to reject reasonable approaches. The LAB verdicts were rechecked against the refined description and none changed.

2.4 Native runs and citation checks

To see how the criteria graded actual work rather than hypothetical responses, I ran both benchmarks natively with GPT-6 Luna (xhigh reasoning) and Claude Opus 5.5 (low reasoning), using each benchmark's own harness, judge models, and aggregation. The two conditions use different reasoning settings and are diagnostics, not a controlled model comparison. For every sampled criterion I could see whether each benchmark's judges passed or failed each model and why (Appendix A).

Because the rubric audit turned up rubrics and task documents that appeared to rely on fabricated case law, I separately had AI agents check every citation in the LAB litigation environments against CourtListener, and then reviewed a random sample of the flagged citations myself under a pre-committed stopping rule. A separate AI citation census covered the LegalReasonBench litigation documents. Appendix B reports both.

2.5 What the design can and cannot estimate

The samples are random draws from the flagged frames, so the exact one-sided 95% hypergeometric lower bound on the number of defective criteria within each frame is well defined, and I report it. Four limits follow. First, the bound concerns the flagged criteria only; a defect neither model flagged is not counted, so the true number may be higher. Second, the count is of criteria, not independent mistakes: one missing affidavit makes six criteria defective, and a criterion sample is not a random sample of tasks or matters. Third, the bound covers sampling uncertainty conditional on my verdicts, not uncertainty about my judgment; one reviewer, who is also the author, applied the protocol. Fourth, the audit does not correct any score. It does not say how a model's ranking would change if the defective criteria were fixed, and it does not extend to the other practice areas or to either benchmark's private material.

3 Results

Table 1 gives the two reviews side by side. Three things should be read with it. The frames differ, so the two confirmation rates do not rank the benchmarks. The estimates concern flagged criteria: the lower bounds of 383 and 45 correspond to 13.4% and 25.1% of the respective audited populations, the point estimates to 18.7% and 29.6%, and neither counts defects the screening missed. And the intervals cover sampling uncertainty only. Several sampled criteria share one underlying problem; the six LegalReasonBench affidavit criteria are not six independent discoveries, though repeated criteria do not invalidate the finite-population inference from a random criterion sample.

	Harvey LAB public litigation tasks	LegalReasonBench public litigation assignments
Audited scope	52 tasks	11 assignments in 4 matters
Criteria	2,858	179
AI-flagged frame	835	63
Human-reviewed sample	25 (19 tasks)	25 (9 assignments)
Defective	16	21
of which objective error	9	7
of which professional judgment	7	14
Arguable	3	0
Not defective	6	4
From a defective environment	14	12
Defective within frame, point estimate	534	53
Defective within frame, 95% lower bound	383	45
as a share of all audited criteria	13.4%	25.1%
Objective errors within frame, lower bound	171	11

Table 1: Human review of random samples of AI-flagged criteria. The frames differ (Section 2); the lower bounds are exact one-sided 95% hypergeometric bounds within each frame, conditional on the reviewer's verdicts. Point-estimate shares of all audited criteria are 18.7% and 29.6%.

The split between objective errors and professional judgment is the paper's organizing fact. In LAB, 9 of the 16 defective criteria rest on an objective error: the environment's time entries add up to $215,680 while the rubric's answer assumes $193,372.50; the rubric states the opposite of Georgia tortious-interference law; the rubric demands a definition that the court's local rules already supply; the rubric finds a conflict in a preservation notice that contains none. The other seven fail work a careful litigator could appropriately produce. In LegalReasonBench, 7 of 21 are objective and 14 are professional judgment; 6 arise from the task materials rather than the criterion alone. I use "reviewer-classified objective error" advisedly. Two of the LegalReasonBench objective calls rest in part on an analogy to another state's statute or concede that the required proposition is narrowly true in the abstract, and the appendix entries say so. Readers who would move those two to the judgment column can do so without changing the picture.

Agreement between the two AI auditors was informative in both benchmarks. In LAB, 9 of the 10 sampled criteria flagged by both models were defective, against 7 of 15 flagged by one. In LegalReasonBench, all 12 criteria flagged by both blind reports were defective, against 9 of 13. The rejected flags matter too. In LAB, 6 sampled criteria were sound, including a custodian-prioritization criterion the auditors called stylistic and I think is a fair expectation on that record. In LegalReasonBench, 4 were sound, including two criteria the auditors flagged because the underlying expert testimony and staff report were not attached, where other supplied documents established

that both existed.

The native runs show why criterion-level defects matter under all-pass scoring. Across the 52 LAB litigation tasks, GPT-6 Luna passed 83.8% of criteria and Claude Opus 5.5 passed 90.8%, averaging the two judges. The all-pass rate across judge-task cells was 1.9% for Luna and 2.9% for Opus, and for each model exactly one task was passed outright by both judges. High criterion pass rates and near-zero task pass rates coexist mechanically: a task with 50 criteria fails if one is failed. The rule does not relabel the other 49, and a genuine critical omission can rightly sink a deliverable. But it means a single defective criterion is enough to fail a task, and the sampled criteria did that: both models failed the motion-to-dismiss brief on a criterion that required them to argue a disputed factual account a court cannot credit at that stage (Section 4.4). These figures do not establish that the benchmark is saturated, and I do not claim it. They establish that the headline number is unusually sensitive to the validity of each criterion.

The citation checks (Appendix B) are a secondary result. In the LAB litigation environments, an AI check of 3,618 citation occurrences found 436 apparently unintentional errors in citations to real authority, including 76 authorities that could not be found; I reviewed a random sample under a pre-committed rule, confirmed ten of ten, and the corresponding lower bound is that at least 303 of the 436 are real errors. The LegalReasonBench census found a much lower problem rate on a different counting unit; the two are not a contest.

4 How the criteria misgrade legal work

The exhibits below are organized by mechanism, not by benchmark. Each gives the task context, the criterion as written, the human assessment, and how the benchmark's own judges graded the saved runs. The complete review of all 50 sampled criteria is in Appendices D and E.

4.1 Stating is not asserting

The 60.5% penalty that opens this paper is the clearest case.

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Penalty criterion, −30 points.** States in Assignment #2 that the 2023 Illinois Annual Report Statistics report a 60.5% clearance rate in Cook County, Illinois.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_18`, forum non conveniens, assignment 2, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

The report in the record does say 60.5%. The defendants' motion relies "principally" on it. A response brief has to answer it, and the rubric's own criteria 19 and 20 reward the answer, which is the civil-case comparison. The only way to make that point persuasively is to name the defendants' figure and show what it measures. The penalty judge, however, sees only the criterion text and is told to answer pass if the response commits the failure. Both saved responses were penalized by all three judges. Opus's brief set out the civil rates and explained why the all-case rate is the wrong comparator; Luna's said the figure "expressly covers all case types" and gave it limited weight. Only a brief that relied on the 60.5% figure as the right measure of congestion should be penalized. I coded this as a professional-judgment defect: the text, the votes, and the point contribution are observable facts, and the assessment that quoting an adversary's figure to rebut it is permissible advocacy is a professional conclusion. I do not think it is a close one.

The same mechanism appears in a criminal appeal in the jury-instruction matter, where a −5

penalty fires if the brief "mentions" that the defendant pled guilty in state court to intimidation with a dangerous weapon. The plea concerns a different incident, and the criterion is plainly meant to test whether the model keeps the two apart. Opus was penalized, two votes to one, for a drafting note that told the supervising lawyer it had decided *not* to rely on the other incident because it was unrelated. A note that mentions a fact in order to set it aside is correct work. The assignment-1 forum non conveniens rubric has a third penalty of the same form ("Mentions ... that Cook County lacks interest"), which did not fire on the saved runs but would fire on a memo that stated the defendants' argument and then explained why the uploaded authority defeats it.

What these criteria share is that they test for the presence of a proposition rather than its function. In legal writing the function is everything: the same sentence is a concession in one paragraph and the setup for a rebuttal in the next.

4.2 Proposed evidence is not evidence

The second forum non conveniens assignment asks for the opposition brief and says, "Please include all affidavits and information you referenced from Assignment #1." The record names five Cook County physicians a lawyer on the team has spoken to and reports that they are willing to testify. No affidavit from any of them, or from the plaintiff, is in the record, and the prompt states that a document not uploaded "does not exist for purposes of this analysis." Ten criteria then award points for stating that the response is supported by each physician's affidavit and that each affidavit shows DuPage County would be inconvenient for the affiant, and an eleventh does the same for the plaintiff's own affidavit; six of the eleven were in my sample.

Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench

> **Reward criterion, +3 points.** States in Assignment #2 that the response is supported by the affidavit of Liam Vance, a physician who provided care to Baby Davis at Cook County Hospital.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_1`, forum non conveniens, assignment 2, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

Opus's brief states that "Plaintiff submits sworn affidavits from five named Cook County treating physicians" and that "[e]ach of the five treating physicians has executed an affidavit in the same form ... separately signed," then attaches one unsigned template with "[Name]" and "[specialty]" blanks. All three judges credited it. Luna's brief, which identifies the five as physicians "with whom counsel has spoken" and cites no affidavit, received nothing on these criteria. The instruction can be read to invite drafting proposed affidavits, and drafting a form for a witness to review is ordinary practice. What the criteria reward is something else: a representation to the court that supporting evidence has already been executed. A nonparty witness decides what she is willing to swear to, and five physicians do not sign one lawyer's form on schedule. The hazard is that a human lawyer, through inadvertence, files a brief that says the affidavits exist. The scoring system here credited the representation and gave nothing to the brief that declined to make it. I coded these as professional-judgment defects arising from the environment, because the drafting instruction admits competing readings; the right fix is either to supply executed affidavits or to reward bracketed placeholders that say the affidavits are contemplated.

A rejected flag in the land-use matter marks the boundary. There, two criteria reward a brief for citing the expert testimony and the staff report that supported the county's rezoning. Neither document is attached, and the auditors flagged both criteria on that ground. But the petition

quotes the testimony with transcript citations and other supplied documents establish that the staff report exists. A competent lawyer would cite both. A missing attachment does not bar a supported inference; the defect in the affidavit criteria is that proposed evidence silently becomes completed evidence. Both saved responses, incidentally, failed both land-use criteria, which is the benchmark working as intended.

4.3 "No conflict" is an answer

Two criteria, one in each benchmark, require the model to find a discrepancy that is not there.

In LAB's preservation-notice task, a Department of Justice notice defines the relevant period as January 1, 2019 forward, "unless otherwise specified herein," and then provides that "[n]otwithstanding the Relevant Period defined in Paragraph 12," certain financial records must be preserved from January 1, 2017. Criterion C-002 requires the memo to recommend seeking clarification from the DOJ "regarding the conflicting date ranges." There is no conflict. The notice sets a general period and an express longer period for one category, which is a common and clearly drafted request. Luna's memo read it correctly, said the two periods were complementary, and was failed by both judges. Opus's memo was failed by one judge and passed by the other, on the strength of an unrelated clarification request about category numbering.

In LegalReasonBench's police-discipline matter, criterion 8 of the first assignment awards 28 of 71 available points for identifying "that the comparator memorandum's stated coverage years conflict with the dates of the cases it summarizes."

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +28 points.** Identifies that the comparator memorandum's stated coverage years conflict with the dates of the cases it summarizes.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_8`, police discipline, assignment 1, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

The memorandum says it reviewed records covering calendar years 2018 through 2021. Its four cases arose in August 2018, November 2019, May 2020, and March 2021 and were resolved between January 2019 and October 2021. Every date is inside the window. Both saved responses correctly reported no conflict and received zero of 28 points. A response that invented one would have been paid for it. The planted discrepancy may have been intended for another document; as written, the criterion cannot be satisfied truthfully.

These two are accessible to readers without litigation experience, and they show the cost of a rubric that always needs one more issue. Recognizing that there is nothing to flag is a skill. A rubric built as a list of things to find cannot reward it.

4.4 The posture governs what can be argued

LAB's Rule 12(b)(6) motion-to-dismiss task asks for a brief seeking dismissal of a software-licensing complaint. Criterion C-045 requires the brief to identify the plaintiff's own failures, a 45-day project-manager gap and late API specifications, "as causes of the Go-Live delay." Those facts come from the defendant's internal status report. The complaint references the report but disputes its account of causation. On a motion to dismiss, the court takes the complaint's well-pleaded allegations as true, and a referenced document can be considered but not credited over the complaint's contrary allegations. Proximate cause is ordinarily a question of fact. Both saved briefs declined to argue the disputed causal account, and both cover memos said why; both were failed on C-045 by both

judges. Correcting C-045 would not by itself have passed either brief, which had many other failed criteria. It would have stopped the rubric from penalizing the one procedural judgment on which both models were right.

A neighboring criterion on the same task shows a different way the governing law can be wrong. C-037 requires the brief to cite "relevant Delaware authority on the parol evidence rule and integration clauses, such as SIGA Technologies v. PharmAthene or Eagle Industries v. DeVilbiss." The issue in the task is whether a plaintiff can plead reliance on pre-contract representations despite a non-reliance clause, which is a different doctrine from parol evidence. The task's research memo quotes both cited cases for propositions that do not appear in them; the quoted language about integration clauses is not in *SIGA* at the cited page, and the quoted holding is not in *Eagle*. Opus read both cases, recognized they were inapposite, cited on-point authority instead, and was failed by both judges for doing better research than the rubric's author. The citation check in Appendix B found problems in 28 of the 53 citations in this task's documents.

4.5 One lawyer's strategy is not the only one

The remaining defects are of the second kind. The criterion does not contradict the record or the law. It takes a question on which careful lawyers differ and fails every answer but one.

LAB's motion in limine task is the contested example, and I present it as such. A damages expert's report itemizes five categories that sum to $14,211,000 and states total damages of $14,200,000. At her deposition she attributed the $11,000 gap to rounding. The task's internal strategy memo proposes the gap as a cumulative point in a *Daubert* motion, on the theory that it shows the report lacked rigor. Criterion C-009 fails any motion that does not identify the discrepancy; its companion C-010, which was not sampled, requires the motion to tie it to exclusion. All four saved grades on C-009 are passes, and the judges split on Luna's treatment of C-010, one of them failing Luna for downplaying the point. My view is that the better motion leaves this out. An $11,000 rounding difference in a $14.2 million calculation is not a reliability problem, and offering it as one tells the judge the moving party has nothing better. Another advocate might include it in a footnote and move on. What the rubric does is make omission a failing answer, and under all-pass scoring that means a motion which concentrates on the expert's real methodological problems fails the task. I coded C-009 as a professional-judgment defect, not an objective error, and readers who think the point belongs in the motion should weigh it accordingly. The question the criterion cannot ask is whether the lawyer decided well.

The pattern is not confined to one task. A conflicts-memo criterion in LAB requires the memo to recommend screening an associate who shares an apartment with his sister, an in-house paralegal at the adverse party; informed consent and a confidentiality protocol would be a perfectly permissible resolution, and the same task's other criteria accept consent for comparable conflicts. A case-assessment criterion requires recommending a motion to dismiss an unjust-enrichment count pleaded in the alternative to a contract claim the rubric itself calls strong, where the motion would not reduce exposure or narrow discovery. In LegalReasonBench's land-use matter, two criteria worth 20 points each require the county's memo to recommend both an appeal and a remand to the hearing examiner, when curing the defects on remand without an appeal is a course many government lawyers would prefer; the real county did both, and its own appellate filing acknowledged the remand might moot the appeal. In each case the required answer is permissible. The failed answers are too.

5 Rules, standards, and rubrics

5.1 A speed limit in fog

Suppose the posted limit is 55 miles per hour. Driving at 60 breaks the rule, and a court does not need to hear argument about it. Driving at 54 in dense fog may nevertheless be negligent, because the law also requires a speed that is reasonable and prudent under the conditions; New York's statute states both requirements in one section, Veh. & Traf. Law § 1180(a), (b). An examiner who marks the 60 as a pass has contradicted the rule. An examiner who marks every speed below 55 as a pass has ignored the standard. And an examiner who insists that the only competent speed in fog was exactly 35 has turned one reasonable choice into the sole correct answer, which the law never did.

Legal work combines the two kinds of question throughout. What the record says, what the statute provides, whether the figures add, whether a document is privileged on these facts, what a court may consider on a motion to dismiss: those are rules, and a rubric can check them, provided the rubric's author got them right. Which arguments to lead with, whether a weak point belongs in the motion at all, whether to appeal or cure the defect on remand, how to resolve a conflict the professional-conduct rules leave to judgment: those are standards. Legal theory has long distinguished the two forms [27]; what matters here is that the audited criteria mishandle both. Sections 4.1 through 4.4 are criteria that get rules wrong. Section 4.5 is criteria that treat standards as rules.

5.2 De novo and abuse of discretion

Appellate review is built on the same distinction. A question of law is reviewed de novo, and the appellate court's answer controls. A discretionary decision is reviewed for abuse of discretion: the trial court has a band within which it may act, and the reviewing court may not substitute its own preference for a decision inside the band. The analogy should not be pushed too far. De novo review allocates decisional authority; it does not mean every legal question has an obvious answer. And deference has limits: a court "by definition abuses its discretion when it makes an error of law," *Koon v. United States*, 518 U.S. 81, 100 (1996), so a standard can still produce a clear violation. But the structure is the right one for evaluating a lawyer's work. The Supreme Court used it in *Strickland v. Washington*, 466 U.S. 668, 688–89 (1984), which recognizes "a wide range of reasonable professional assistance" and explains that "[n]o particular set of detailed rules for counsel's conduct can satisfactorily take account of the variety of circumstances faced by defense counsel or the range of legitimate decisions regarding how best to represent" a client. *Strickland*'s floor is too low to define excellent work. Its recognition that competent lawyers legitimately differ is exactly what a rubric that fails the omission of an $11,000 rounding point lacks.

The closest prior work in the evaluation literature draws the same line from a different source. Nagl's survey of grading open-text legal answers builds on German examination law, under which a solution that is defensible and consistently argued may not be marked wrong, while weak argumentation may still earn fewer points: "Latitude protects the result, not the mark" [17]. The survey identifies defensible alternative solutions and follow-on errors as the largest validation gap for LLM rubric judges. That is the gap this audit documents in two live benchmarks.

Three things follow for rubric design. A rubric should enforce rules, and its author should be held to the record and the law when it does. A rubric may apply a standard only when the judge applying it can add real signal: "keep the statement of facts under three pages" can be checked; "organize

the argument so the court finds the dispositive point first" needs a judge that can tell. And a rubric should not fail an answer inside the band of professional discretion. The evaluator that does so has, in the appellate phrase, exceeded its own authority. This does not flatten every reasonable choice into the same score. A benchmark that wants to measure elite work must still prefer excellent work to merely adequate work, and comparative judgment, not a checklist, is the instrument for that (Section 6).

5.3 Materiality is a separate axis

One refinement keeps the frame honest. Whether a question has a right answer is independent of whether getting it wrong matters. A typographical error is objectively wrong and immaterial. An unsupported statement that a critical affidavit has been signed is objectively unsupported and consequential. "Objectively wrong" should not automatically mean "the task fails," which is what all-pass scoring makes it mean, and "professional judgment" should not automatically mean "minor," because the affidavit criteria are judgment calls with real consequences. The audit records both axes separately, and a benchmark should too.

5.4 More arguments are not better lawyering

One response to the second kind of defect is that a rubric which elicits an additional defensible point, even one a lawyer might omit, is at worst harmless: the model learns to raise more. I think that is wrong, and it is the point in this paper I most want to land.

The range of plausible-sounding arguments available in any position far exceeds what a court, an adversary, or a client will consider. A defendant may contest personal jurisdiction, venue, process, and service of process at the outset of nearly every case, and must raise them in its first response or lose them, Fed. R. Civ. P. 12(h)(1). It is rare that more than one of them is worth raising, and an objection to process or service, even when technically available, usually buys a corrected summons and a judge who has now read the defendant's weakest argument first. Every lawyer learns to winnow. The Supreme Court said so in holding that appointed appellate counsel need not raise every nonfrivolous issue a client wants raised: "Experienced advocates since time beyond memory have emphasized the importance of winnowing out weaker arguments on appeal and focusing on one central issue if possible, or at most on a few key issues," *Jones v. Barnes*, 463 U.S. 745, 751–52 (1983), and, quoting Justice Jackson, "[l]egal contentions, like the currency, depreciate through over-issue," *id.* at 752 (quoting Robert H. Jackson, Advocacy Before the Supreme Court, 25 Temp. L.Q. 115, 119 (1951)).

The reason is attention. There is a context window for the model, and there is also one for the reader: the judge who gives the motion twenty minutes, the adversary deciding whether the letter is serious, the client's general counsel reading the memo on a phone. A second-tier argument does not sit harmlessly beside the first-tier one. It dilutes it, signals that the author could not tell the difference, and spends credibility the strong argument needed. Practitioners have begun to see this in a different form: negotiators now complain of receiving AI-generated contract markups that propose dozens of trivial changes to boilerplate with a settled meaning. That is an observation from practice, not a finding of this audit. But the audited criteria point the same way. A rubric that fails a motion for omitting a rounding error, or a conflicts memo for choosing consent over screening, is training the model to include. It cannot train the model to choose.

The principle I would extract is this. A benchmark that claims to measure professional judgment must distinguish discovering an argument from deciding that the argument belongs in the deliverable,

and it must be able to accept a sound answer its author did not anticipate. Whether an omission is sound depends on the assignment, the audience, the stakes, and the alternatives. A comprehensive internal memorandum should cover more than a brief. That is a reason to write the rubric to the assignment, not a reason to reward coverage everywhere.

6 What a rubric reward needs

Rubric-based rewards are now a standard tool for extending reinforcement learning beyond domains with checkable answers, and the published work on them is more careful than the audited criteria. Gunjal and colleagues show that instance-specific rubrics can outperform direct judge scores as rewards in medicine and science [21]. Yu and colleagues route each criterion either to a deterministic verifier or to a model judge, weight essential criteria above supplementary ones, and report that the split reduces exploitable false positives [20]. Shao and colleagues let rubrics evolve during training from retrieved evidence and contrasts among responses, rather than freezing a checklist [22]. In law specifically, Lee and colleagues build hierarchical issue trees from court judgments and report that reinforcement learning against them improved correctness "albeit with reduced coverage," which is a direct observation of a reward trading one skill for another [19]. Yang and colleagues find on 30 legal tasks that attorneys' pairwise comparisons recover a constructed quality ordering far better than rubric scores, with a mean per-task rank correlation of 0.908 against 0.150 [18]; the quality levels were constructed and the tested rubrics were particular ones, so the result is support for comparative judgment as a complement rather than a verdict on rubrics. And Gao, Schulman, and Hilton showed in a controlled setting that optimizing against a proxy reward eventually diverges from a stronger gold evaluator [23], which is the general reason to validate a reward independently of the policy it trained.

Harvey's own work belongs on this list. Its study of lawyer preference on 24 LAB tasks, three lawyers per task, found only modest agreement on any particular task (Fleiss' κ of 0.129, unanimity on a quarter of items), and found that model judges were "willing to trade-off critical hallucinations or mistakes for other features in ways lawyers found unacceptable" [10]. That is a candid statement of the aggregation problem, and it supports the materiality point above.

I would describe what this literature supports as evidence-informed design principles rather than settled best practice, and Table 2 sets them against what the audit found. The pattern is that the audited criteria are fixed content checklists applied by a judge that sees the criterion and the response and nothing else. They do not separate what can be verified against the record from what needs judgment, do not weight essential against supplementary, do not provide for defensible alternatives, and in LAB's case do not distinguish a critical omission from a trivial one when the task is scored.

Measurement theory supplies the vocabulary for the two kinds of failure. Messick distinguishes construct underrepresentation, where an assessment misses important parts of the ability it claims to measure, from construct-irrelevant variance, where scores move for reasons unrelated to that ability [26]. The defects documented here are the second kind, and they are errors of commission: a criterion introduces an incorrect requirement or rewards an unsupported proposition. The first kind, omission, is a hypothesis this audit cannot test. My impression from reading all 2,858 LAB litigation criteria and all 179 LegalReasonBench criteria is that nearly all of them specify content to include and few ask whether the model selected, prioritized, or qualified well. micro1's own classification assigns 57% of positive weight to Application and 5% to Issue [13], so "issue spotting" is the wrong label; "predetermined content" is the right one. Testing that impression would take

Principle	Source	Where the audited criteria diverge
Check requirements against the record and the law with a verifier, not only a judge's reading	[20]; [17]	Criteria that credit nonexistent affidavits, require a date conflict the record lacks, or state Georgia law backwards
Credit defensible alternatives; latitude protects the result, not the mark	[17]	Screening versus consent; appeal-and-remand versus remand; the rounding footnote
Judge the function of a statement, not its presence	[18]; [10]	"States" and "mentions" penalties that fire on rebuttals
Weight essential above supplementary; do not let a minor item decide the task	[20]	All-pass scoring with no materiality tier
Validate the reward against an evaluator it was not optimized for	[23]; [26]	Training on LAB and reporting LAB (Section 7)

Table 2: Design principles from the rubric-reward literature and the audited criteria that diverge from them.

a declared taxonomy and a coverage inventory of both benchmarks, which I have not done. The preservation-notice criterion shows why the distinction matters: that task did involve interpretation, a general provision and an express exception, and the defect was that the rubric evaluated the interpretation wrongly, not that interpretation was absent.

7 What the scores establish, and what the training gains do not

7.1 Reading the scores

A defect rate cannot be subtracted from a score. A criterion that misgrades every model the same way leaves the ordering unchanged; a smaller number of criteria that misgrade models differently can move it. Which happened here is unknown, because the audit graded criteria and not model outputs across the full set. What the audit supports is narrower and, I think, sufficient: the robustness of reported performance differences to substantive correction of the criteria has not been established, and establishing it would require paired regrading of actual outputs on the same evaluation set. On Artificial Analysis's current private LAB leaderboard, the leading models' criterion pass rates sit in the low-to-mid nineties while the hallucination-gated all-pass headline is around 13% [14]. That version uses updated private tasks and is not the release I audited, and Artificial Analysis states that its scores are not comparable across versions. I note it only because the structure is the same: the gaps between leading models on criterion pass rate are a few points, and the audited defect rate in the public litigation set is larger than those gaps. That is a reason to ask the robustness question, not an answer to it.

The comparison that invites itself is to coding. In February 2026 OpenAI stopped reporting SWE-bench Verified after an audit of its own found problems with test requirements and task specification [15]. As models improve, errors in a benchmark that once went unnoticed appear as failures of models that are now better than the benchmark. Legal evaluation has reached that point in at least these two public sets.

7.2 The evidence on legal reinforcement learning

Models have become much better at legal work over the past several years. The deeper question is how much of that came from legal-specific training rather than from general improvement, and in particular whether legal reinforcement learning against rubric rewards is adding capability or fitting proxies. I cannot answer that question, and this audit does not try to. What I can do is say what the public evidence establishes and where it is thin.

Three propositions need to be kept apart: that training improves a model's score on a legal benchmark; that it improves the legal work practitioners care about; and that legal specialization improves that work beyond what an otherwise comparable frontier model already does. Evidence for the first does not establish the second or the third, and the audit is a direct challenge to the inference between them. If a criterion rewards an unsupported assertion or penalizes a correct rebuttal, improved compliance with it is not evidence of better lawyering, however consistently the judge applies it.

The published results are mostly of the first kind. Applied Compute reports full-parameter reinforcement learning on GLM-5.1 with LAB as the reward, graded by a model judge, and an improvement on a held-out LAB split from a 0.853 to a 0.913 rubric pass rate, with the all-pass rate rising from 0.059 to 0.126; its grader was validated by agreement between two frontier models, and no practitioner evaluation of the outputs is described [12]. Harvey's Tenet, trained from a Kimi K3 base by asynchronous reinforcement learning with a model judge over each task's rubric, reports gains on LAB and transfer to two separately developed benchmarks, APEX Agents and RedlineBench, with the harness differences disclosed [11]; the reported Elo gain of roughly 130 over its base and preference in more than two of three comparisons come from a generative reward model, not from a blinded human trial [10]. Transfer to independently built benchmarks is more informative than improvement on one, and these are substantive training results. But their principal quality endpoint is rubric scoring of the kind audited here, and agreement among model graders does not establish that the criteria measure sound legal work.

Two results sit closer to independent validation, and neither isolates the question. The technical report for the Thomson model describes more than 3,000 blind expert-rated comparisons across legal and general sets, in which its system was preferred over each of five external systems; the authors call it a downstream system demonstration rather than an isolation of the model's contribution, and the compared systems had different tool and data access [24]. LegalOne releases weights for a family of Chinese legal models trained through mid-training, supervised fine-tuning, and a curriculum reinforcement learning stage, which shows that open legal-RL models exist, but its evaluations are constrained legal tasks on smaller models and the release does not supply the matched checkpoints immediately before and after the RL stage that an outside researcher would need [25]. So it is not accurate to say that every finding about legal RL is downstream of rubric benchmarks. Some use constrained correct-answer tasks; some specialized-system evaluations use lawyers directly. The intersection that matters, frontier capability, an isolated RL intervention, and independent validation of professional quality, is where I found nothing.

I want to be precise about the burden. The paper does not have to show that legal RL contributes nothing, and I do not believe that. It has to show that the measure on which the gains are reported does not, on its own, license the inference to better professional work. The audit shows that. The response "but the score went up" answers a question the audit did not ask.

7.3 What independent validation would look like

Independent does not have to mean rubric-free. It means an assessment that does not reproduce the assumptions in dispute. A second rubric benchmark with the same construction method is weak corroboration; a second model judge applying the same defective requirement is almost none. What would count: blinded practitioner comparisons on independently prepared matters; source checks of factual assertions against the record; assessment of consequential omissions and of what the lawyer chose to leave out; tests built from matched pairs, where a small change in the facts should change the answer and a superficial change should not; and separately developed, expert-validated criteria for the rule-like requirements. Lawyer preference is not an unquestioned ground truth either, as Harvey's own agreement figures show. It is, however, the only place the standard-like half of the work can be measured at all.

8 How the rubrics were made

I want to be careful here, because the people who built these benchmarks did something no one else had, and the evidence does not support conclusions about why a given criterion went wrong.

What is public is this. Harvey's launch post names Mercor and Snorkel AI as contributing research groups, and a slide from a later talk by Harvey's co-founder describes those providers as running expert review and verification of every generated LAB task [7, 8]. In comments on an earlier draft of this paper, Harvey told me that the outside providers had a more limited role on the public LAB tasks than on the held-out set used for the Artificial Analysis evaluation. A public clarification by one of LAB's authors describes substantial internal lawyer review [9]. None of this establishes task-by-task authorship or the arrangements under which particular criteria were written and checked. micro1 states that a practicing lawyer authored each matter and its rubrics end to end, and reports a three-judge classification of its criteria into IRAC categories with high agreement [13]; that classification is not a substantive validation of each criterion, and the public sample contains no record of one.

What the audit can say is that expert authorship and expert review did not, by themselves, produce valid criteria. A rubric that states Georgia law backwards, a research memo that quotes language not in the cited cases, a criterion that rewards a date conflict the record does not contain: these are errors a second lawyer reading the task against its sources would catch, and in the public sets they were not caught. How tasks and rubrics are made is not disclosed in either benchmark, and in other domains that matters less, because automated checks validate the environment. This audit shows that in law those checks were not done or did not work. The reasonable demand is disclosure: who authored and reviewed each task, what sources reviewers could inspect, how disagreements were resolved, and how corrections are versioned. The reasonable inference is that producing valid legal rubrics at scale is harder than it looked, and that whatever process produced these needs a verification step that reproduces, rather than samples, the work.

Synthetic records produce one failure mode and adapted real cases produce another. LAB's environments are generated, and the generation introduces inconsistencies that are striking to a practitioner and invisible to a non-lawyer: a state agency that issues OSHA citations to a private employer in a state with no federally approved plan for private employers; an invoice whose line items do not sum to its subtotal; a complaint that quotes the forum-selection clause it is violating. Appendix C walks through one task. The OSHA environment is worth a note because my review coded the sampled criterion on that task as not defective: the rubric only asked the memo to address

the citation, and a memo can do that while noticing the environment is incoherent. The harder question is what a model should do with knowledge it has from pretraining that the environment contradicts. A good lawyer brings prior knowledge to every record and looks for what seems out of place. A reward that pays only for working within the supplied documents could, in principle, teach a model to stop doing that. I present that as a hypothesis about a training mechanism, not as something this audit observed.

LegalReasonBench's adapted matters fail differently. Twice in my sample the criterion was correct for the real case and wrong for the task, because the task had changed the facts and the rubric had not followed. In the police-discipline matter, the rubric rewards the proposition that no uploaded authority requires the department to prove the comparability of its comparator cases, which was the department's argument in the real litigation; in the task, the department's own final notice relies on the comparators as an aggravating factor, and the uploaded *Douglas* factors place the burden on the agency. In the jury-instruction matter, the rubric awards 25 points for noting a lack of evidence about who fired first, which was disputed in the real case; the task's closed-universe statement of facts says who fired first. Both saved responses declined to assert what the record contradicted and received nothing. Real-case adaptation can break the coherence among instructions, record, law, and expected answer just as generation can.

9 Directions

Three directions follow from the audit, and I state each at the level the evidence supports.

Test the skills that cut across matters. The commission defects are established; the omission hypothesis is not, and it is the more important one. The skills law school teaches as "thinking like a lawyer" are few and codified: reading text with its exceptions and interacting provisions, reasoning from authority and distinguishing it, respecting procedural posture and burdens, identifying what is missing from a record, and judging what is material. The canons of interpretation are a published taxonomy of one of these skills, though they vary in authority and their interaction is itself contested, so recognizing a canon's name is not the same as selecting and applying it in an unfamiliar matter. Existing benchmarks test some of this; LegalBench includes interpretation tasks [29]. What I did not find in either audited benchmark is a deliberate attempt to cover that universe and to test whether a principle learned in one matter transfers to another. That is a coverage study, and it would turn an impression into a result.

Learn from the reasoning that already exists. Published judicial opinions are a vast body of reasoned decisions, each stating facts, competing positions, the court's resolution, and often the court's reasons for rejecting the losing argument. In the United States they are public domain as government edicts, *Georgia v. Public.Resource.Org, Inc.*, 590 U.S. 255 (2020), which is not true of the briefs and exhibits filed alongside them. They are published explanations of decisions, not transcripts of a judge's thinking, and some current work already builds on them [19]. Law school has used them for a century and a half to teach the transferable skills listed above, by having students encounter principles in example after example and then test them on new facts; Singer describes the method and its limits, and the problem-solving cases that start before the facts and issues are settled [28]. That is a design for a learning environment, not a claim that law school is one: reading opinions resembles learning from demonstrations, predicting dispositions is supervised learning, and the Socratic variation of facts is a transfer test. Three targets need to stay distinct in any such

program: predicting what a court did, reconstructing its stated reasoning, and advising competently on the information available before the decision. Success on one is not proof of the others.

Use outcomes as one external signal. LegalForecastBench, my earlier benchmark, asks models to predict how federal judges ruled on motions to dismiss from the record the judge received [16]. Its contribution here is an externally observable label that no rubric author wrote. The proposition that learning to predict how courts and lawyers react to a fact pattern will teach general principles of legal reasoning, as predicting the next token taught general principles of language, is a hypothesis I find attractive and have not tested. Outcome prediction is also a sparse signal, and the audit supplies a reason for care: in the land-use matter the real county pursued the strategy the rubric requires, and I still coded the criterion defective, because actual professional conduct is not the unique correct answer. Denser signals are available in the same records, including issue-level holdings and arguments a court expressly accepted or rejected, with the discipline that silence about an argument is not a negative label and a winning brief is not an ideal one. Developing that method is a separate paper.

For the evaluation problem itself, the approaches worth investigating map onto the failures observed: source checks for assertions that can be verified; context-sensitive judging that can tell endorsement from rebuttal; multiple acceptable response paths for questions inside the band of discretion; comparison against expert specimens for overall quality and materiality; and real-world labels where an outcome exists. Supervised fine-tuning on expert work product and rubrics that are generated or updated during training are candidates, not demonstrated solutions, and if the training reward moves, the evaluation has to stay held out.

10 Limitations and conclusion

The limits are stated above and bear repeating in one place. One reviewer, who is also the author, applied the protocol; an independent second lawyer re-deciding some or all of the 50 items would strengthen the result, and I would welcome it. The samples are from AI-flagged frames, so the bounds are lower bounds on those frames and say nothing about criteria the screening missed. The frames differ between benchmarks. The audited releases are the public litigation sets at pinned revisions, not the private material used for leaderboards or training, and not the other practice areas. The native runs are one execution per model and condition, used as diagnostics. The audit grades criteria and does not correct scores, and nothing in it measures the effect of training against these rewards.

What it shows is this. In two public legal benchmarks built by capable people with expert help, a substantial share of the criteria that AI auditors flagged are wrong in one of two ways. Some contradict the record, the law, or the arithmetic. Some take a decision that belongs to professional judgment and make one answer mandatory. A consistent judge does not cure either defect. A model that improves against either is not thereby a better lawyer, and a score that moves by a few points on either cannot yet be read as a ranking of legal ability. Legal evaluation needs to make room for justified restraint: a model should be able to see a fact, an argument, or a possible criticism, and then correctly decide to qualify it, rebut it, reserve it, or leave it out. Building rubrics that distinguish the rules from the standards, hold the rules to the sources, and leave the standards to a judge that can apply them is the work these two releases have made it possible to start.

Reproducibility, access, and AI use disclosure

Code and audit materials are maintained in the LegalForecastBench repository. The sampling protocols, frozen draws, completed worksheets, stress-test records, native model runs with every judge's reasoning, and both citation checks are in the Harvey LAB and LegalReasonBench audit directories. The counts in this paper are generated from the worksheets, and the build fails if a verdict in an appendix entry disagrees with its worksheet.

As I am a practicing attorney and do not have any formal training in artificial intelligence or machine learning, the use of AI models was essential to allow me to make a research contribution in this space that otherwise would have been beyond my capabilities. My personal contribution included reviewing a random sample of the criteria in each benchmark by hand to validate the AI audit findings, deciding every verdict in the appendices, reviewing the sampled citation findings, conducting a deep dive into one of LAB's litigation tasks, and orchestrating AI coding agents that helped write and execute the code that ran the audits and the native benchmark runs. I wrote most of this paper personally, but discussed the results at several points with AI agents and considered AI-generated analysis as an input into my thinking as I drafted. The major exception to this was the AI audit findings, the citation checks, and other places where numerical results are included; I relied on AI agents to produce those findings, to write code that performs the necessary calculations, and to prepare the LaTeX source summarizing those results. I used several different models from Anthropic, OpenAI, SpaceXAI, and Google to check the work, including an adversarial stress test of each of my verdicts. I also met with experienced researchers in the space to validate the experimental design and results, and obtain feedback on the draft, and I am grateful to several AI researchers in industry positions for helpful discussions. This version of the paper is a working draft, and feedback from researchers, lawyers, and the teams that built these benchmarks on how to improve the audit or make its findings more useful is welcome.

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A Native execution and grading on both benchmarks

To understand how the rubrics evaluated actual AI-generated work product, I ran both benchmarks with GPT-6 Luna (xhigh thinking) and Claude Opus 5.5 (low thinking), using each benchmark's own harness and judges. The examples in Appendices D and E include these outputs, so I could consider how actual model outputs were being graded in evaluating the rubrics. Since the two models ran at different reasoning settings, the difference in their scores is not a controlled comparison of model capability; it was used as a diagnostic. All deliverables, raw judge files, and every criterion's verdicts with the judges' reasoning are published unedited in the audit directories [1, 5].

Harvey LAB

LAB's litigation tasks were run at Harvey commit `1dd81403` with the original instructions, documents, and rubrics. LAB's standard judge pair, Claude Sonnet 4.6 and GPT-5.5, graded every output.

Solver	Effort	Tasks	Criterion pass rate	All-pass cells	All-pass by both judges
GPT-6 Luna	xhigh	52	83.80%	2 of 104 (1.92%)	1 of 52 tasks
Claude Opus 5.5	low	52	90.81%	3 of 104 (2.88%)	1 of 52 tasks

Table 3: Native LAB AI-judge grades on the 52 public litigation tasks. For each task, each judge's fraction of criteria passed is averaged across the two judges and then across tasks with equal weights. An all-pass cell is one judge passing every criterion on one task; there are 104 such cells per solver.

These grades reflect how LAB's judges applied the original rubrics; they are AI judgments and can misapply a criterion. Under LAB's all-pass rule, a run scores 1 with a judge only if every criterion passes, so a single failed criterion on a task zeroes that judge's score for it.

LegalReasonBench

The 11 litigation assignments were run as native multi-step tasks through the upstream harness at dataset revision `1bfa904c`, with assignments within a matter run in order in one persistent sandbox so later assignments could read earlier deliverables. The task-provided verifier graded every criterion with the benchmark's three-judge panel (GPT-5.6 Terra, Claude Sonnet 5, and Gemini 3.8 Flash) by strict majority, and the upstream scorer aggregated signed points. All 22 answers have complete grade panels. The harness recorded a nonzero agent exit diagnostic on 21 of the 22 assignment steps, including EPIPE diagnostics, although every archived agent log ends with a model stop event; the saved responses and complete panels establish the reported grades, but the execution record is not a clean-exit experiment. Matter scores, per-assignment contributions, usage, and reconstructed costs are in the experiment record [5].

	GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)		Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	
Matter	Signed points	Score	Signed points	Score
Land-use certiorari	50/320	15.6%	20/320	6.3%
Police discipline	160/332	48.2%	224/332	67.5%
Jury instructions	25/310	8.1%	60/310	19.4%
Forum non conveniens	2/201	1.0%	107/201	53.2%

Table 4: Native LegalReasonBench matter scores: signed points earned across assignments divided by total positive points, clamped to the unit interval. One execution per model and matter.

The 60.5% penalty discussed in Section 4.1 illustrates the arithmetic. On the second forum non conveniens assignment, with 73 positive points available, Opus earned 33 signed points (45.2%) with the −30 penalty and would have earned 63 (86.3%) without it; Luna earned −14, clamped to zero, and would have earned 16 (21.9%).

B Citation checks of the task environments

Because the rubric audit turned up instances where the rubrics contained hallucinated case law (suggesting that whoever was responsible for verification may have relied on inaccurate AI-generated responses to prepare the answer key), I asked AI agents to conduct a separate citation check of the litigation and dispute resolution tasks to assess the frequency of AI hallucinations in the task environments or rubrics. A citation check is a standard pre-filing procedure where lawyers check every authority cited in a brief, regulatory submission, or other important document to ensure that the authority is cited accurately, contains any quotation attributed to it, and supports the legal proposition for which it is cited.

An initial AI-assisted check of every case citation in the 19 sampled LAB environments against CourtListener, with spot checks, found problems in 45 of 102 citations to purported real authority: 32 real cases cited for holdings, quotations, or facts they do not contain, 7 cases that could not be found, 5 garbled citations to real cases, and 1 citation pointing to a different case [2]. A broader occurrence-based check then covered all 52 tasks. After excluding errors in case law that were intentionally planted and then tested in rubrics (e.g., an error of law in an opponent's submission that the model was supposed to catch), the AI identified 436 errors that were apparently not intended to be part of the task environment [3]:

Finding	All citations	Case citations
Verified	2,754	306
Verified, minor defect (pin cite, loose paraphrase, wrong year)	346	54
Intentional error tested by the rubric (excluded)	31	6
Unintentional errors		
Cited for a proposition it does not support	246	105
Not found (likely fabricated)	76	60
Garbled citation to a real authority	58	10
Quotation not found in the authority	40	31
Reporter citation belongs to a different case	16	12
Total unintentional errors	436	218
Source text not accessible	51	6
Total checked	3,618	590

Table 5: AI citation check of the 52 LAB litigation task environments. This table shows the AI findings; the attorney review below estimates how many are real.

I reviewed a simple random sample of the 436 errors personally. Before I reviewed any sampled finding, I drew 20 citation findings and pre-committed to a stopping rule that if the first ten were all confirmed errors, I would stop; otherwise I'd review 10 more. I reviewed each citation finding and agreed that all ten involved errors a careful lawyer would correct before filing. The AI had correctly classified seven as cited for propositions they do not support and three as real authorities cited by the wrong number or subsection. Three of the ten involved miscitations to the Eleventh Circuit's pattern civil jury instructions. With ten of ten confirmed, a conservative one-sided 95% lower confidence bound is 303 of the 436 flagged errors (69.5%); the calculation accounts for both possible stopping points under the pre-committed rule. I did not attempt to review or identify errors the AI may have missed among citations it marked as verified.

A separate AI citation census covered the LegalReasonBench litigation documents on a different

counting unit: each citation occurrence in a unique matter document, with repeated attachment copies in later assignment packets not counted again. It recorded 2,312 real-authority occurrences: 1,957 verified, 118 with minor defects, 73 problem occurrences (47 mischaracterized, five misquoted, and 21 wrong citations to real cases), and 164 that could not be verified, mostly historical local compilations and agency decisions that no worker could retrieve; seventy references to fictional scenario authorities are excluded, and no citation was labeled fabricated merely because retrieval failed. Every first-stage problem claim received an independent second AI judgment [5]. The observed problem rate is 73 of 2,312 (3.2%). These are AI judgments that I did not sample for attorney review, and because the counting units differ from the LAB check, the two rates should not be read as a contest between the benchmarks.

C A synthetic task environment: the motion-to-dismiss case study

In addition to auditing the accuracy of all 2,858 rubrics, I did a deep dive review of one substantive LAB litigation task. This review highlighted a different but equally important issue: the use of synthetic or AI-generated data may result in task environments that are unrealistic in a variety of subtle ways that may not be obvious to nonexperts but that are striking and clear to practicing attorneys. The task `analyze-counterparty-motion-to-dismiss` asks AI agents to prepare a list of issues for the opposition brief to a motion to dismiss, on a fictitious software service dispute.

I observed several ways in which the synthetically generated task environment seemed unrealistic and could potentially train models on a distorted view of what genuine practice looks like. [4]

Planted issues. A number of the legal disputes in the task environment are obviously "planted" in a way that feels artificial and ultimately presents issues in a way that is meaningfully different from how real-world legal disputes manifest. For example, the contract the parties are suing over has a forum selection clause that requires any lawsuit to be filed in Travis County, Texas. The plaintiff literally quotes this entire provision in the complaint but nevertheless files suit in the Northern District of Georgia and offers no explanation for why they believe the forum selection clause they quoted does not apply or otherwise permits the suit in Georgia. It of course happens regularly that a lazy or incompetent litigant files suit in the wrong forum; a competent lawyer potentially could decide to ignore the clause and hope that their adversary overlooks the issue. But in both of those scenarios, the forum selection clause would not be explicitly flagged in the complaint as it is here; a real version of this legal task would require the lawyer to dig through a number of documents and realize that buried in one of them is a forum selection clause that allows the lawyer to have the case moved to Texas.

This is one example, but a significant number of the tasks in these environments were similarly planted in a way that's artificial and unlike how disputes around these issues arise in real cases. Environments like this can distort an evaluation of a model's true capabilities, since simply looking for the obviously planted issues will satisfy the benchmark without testing whether the model would be able to identify this issue from more realistic source material akin to what it will see in real cases.

Environment Documents Violate Court Rules. Many of the documents in these environments do not resemble real lawyer work product. The environment provides counterparty litigation documents in docx format, and the native files from the git repository often cannot be opened, although agents and various CLI tools can recover the document text. In real litigation, lawyers rarely share their docx files with their opponent; the opponent's memorandum of law is ordinarily filed with the court as a PDF. The motion papers also lack a proper caption, include a stale table of contents, contain markdown formatting artifacts that render in Word as junk characters even in files that can be opened normally, lack citations for propositions that generally require citations, and are single spaced rather than double spaced in violation of the applicable court rules.

The motion that the agent is being asked to respond to is so far below professional norms that you would want any analysis of the motion to include consideration of whether the judge would strike the motion or require it to be refiled in compliance with the rules. That is not included in the rubric for this task because the quality control issues appear to be unintentional, not part of the test for the agent. But it is a genuine gap: if a document like this were filed in real litigation, the quality of the work product could itself become a substantive issue in the litigation and thus would need to be flagged given the goal motivating the all-pass criterion, which was to ensure that the AI does not

overlook any important issues [8, section "Evaluating a task"].

There are valid reasons to prefer rubric-based reinforcement learning approaches. For example, while a benchmark like LegalForecastBench (which asks models to predict how federal judges ruled on motions to dismiss) can test a model's legal reasoning and analytical ability over a narrow task, it does not test the model's ability to generate new work product, which is an important consideration for a company like Harvey that is developing legal agents to prepare and revise different kinds of legal work product. But reviewing these environments suggests that the current state of the art in synthetic data generation introduces drift on a variety of dimensions that could undermine the efficacy of the task environment as a training or evaluation signal. The model is in effect being tested on its ability to recognize a distinct environment, very unlike what it will encounter in production, and adhere to a stylized set of norms and rules that were artificially constructed in that environment but do not comport with the real norms or rules that govern real-world tasks. While creating LegalForecastBench illustrated that there are real challenges in working with real-world litigation data as well, for a variety of tasks that data has a lot of rich, implicit signal that data providers generating synthetic data are unable to capture.

D Human review of AI-flagged LAB criteria

I asked two frontier models, GPT-6 Sol and Claude Opus 5.5, to audit the 52 tasks in LAB's litigation tasks (specifically Harvey commit `1dd81403`). Table 6 reports how many criteria each pass flagged as defective or arguably defective. The combined row is Opus's later review of rubrics already flagged by either pass. A criterion "flagged by either model" was flagged at least once; that is 835 of the 2,858 criteria (29.2%) [1].

Pass	What the model saw	Criteria flagged
GPT-6 Sol	The tasks, without Opus's results	616
Claude Opus 5.5, first pass	The tasks, without Sol's results	650
Claude Opus 5.5, combined	The rubrics flagged by either pass	564
Flagged by either model	Share of all 2,858 criteria	835 (29.2%)

Table 6: AI audit of the 52 litigation tasks at Harvey commit `1dd81403`.

In order to validate the AI findings and determine how many of the AI-flagged rubrics were genuinely defective, I reviewed a simple random sample of 25 of the flagged rubrics, drawn with a fixed seed from 19 tasks. I committed the protocol for that review before it began [2]. For each rubric, I reviewed the grading rubric itself, the findings from both AI auditors, how LAB's AI judges graded two real model runs (GPT-6 Luna and Opus 5.5) on that rubric, and the relevant documents from the task environment. In a few cases I also did research into the relevant governing law. I marked a rubric as defective when it could produce an inaccurate grade, meaning: either the rubric could fail a response that a thoughtful litigator would consider appropriate, or the rubric could pass a response that a thoughtful litigator would consider wrong on the issue the rubric is testing. A rubric that forces one of several permissible answers is therefore defective, because it would fail the others.

During the review, I decided to distinguish between defects in the rubrics themselves and defects in the task environment. The line between the two was based on whether the defect could change the grade a model is given on the task. For example, one rubric wanted the work product to contain a specific metric sourced from the task environment, but the AI auditors pointed out that the task environment actually contained two contradictory numbers for that particular metric. Accordingly, an AI agent that relied on one of the numbers (which was not the one the rubric was expecting) would be failed incorrectly because of the underlying defect in the task environment. I treated that as a defect in both the rubric and the task environment. By contrast, a different task environment contained a notice of an OSHA regulatory violation from a state-level regulatory agency in Ohio that does not actually have jurisdiction over the violations charged. The rubric wanted work product to simply flag the existence of the charge in the work product. I coded that as a defect in the task environment but not as a defect in the rubric (because an AI agent handed that task could, and likely still would, pass the rubric by simply mentioning the charged violation).

Of the 25 criteria, I graded 16 rubrics defective in ways that affect grading, including 9 that I considered to be unambiguous objective errors in which the record, the law, the cited authority, or the arithmetic contradicts the rubric. 3 were arguable defects, and 6 were not defective. 14 of the 25 come from task environments that contain defects (10 of the 19 tasks). Only 4 had neither a defective nor an arguable criterion and came from an environment without a defect (Table 7).

Since the sample was a draw without replacement from the 835 criteria that AI agents had flagged as defective, the one-sided 95% lower confidence bounds are: at least 383 flagged criteria are defective

in ways that affect grading (point estimate 534; the bound is 13.4% of all criteria in the practice area); at least 171 are unambiguous objective errors (point estimate 301); and at least 319 come from task environments that contain defects (point estimate 468). At least 524 involve a defective criterion, a defective environment, or both (point estimate 668). In the sample, 9 of the 10 criteria flagged by both auditors were defective, against 7 of the 15 flagged by only one.

I did not attempt to estimate defects in criteria that were not flagged by the AI agents; it is possible there could be some additional defects that the agents did not flag. These estimates count criteria/rubrics, not the individual mistakes that give rise to the defects. In some cases, the defect was specific to the particular rubric at issue, but in other cases, a single error in a task environment could make several criteria defective. After I prepared an initial set of verdicts, I asked AI models (GPT-6.1 Sol and Opus 5.5) to stress test my answers and to draft additional arguments both for and against each call and a summary of those they would change. I changed a handful of verdicts after reflecting on these points, and did a second pass through the full set of my verdicts to ensure that they applied the principles I adopted during the review consistently to each call.

The audit of rubrics revealed instances where the task environment, and sometimes grading rubrics, appeared to rely on AI-generated hallucinated case law citations. The citation checks that followed are reported in Appendix B; several entries below cite their per-task results.

Criterion verdict	Environment defective	Environment correct	Total
Defective	10	6	16
Arguable	2	1	3
Not defective	2	4	6
Total	14	11	25

Table 7: My verdicts on the 25 sampled criteria, by whether the task environment itself contains a defect.

The sampled criteria

Each entry has four parts: (1) the criterion quoted verbatim from Harvey's task file (that text is from Harvey's data vendors, not me, and in many cases the text appears to be AI-generated), (2) my verdict on the criterion and task environment, (3) results from a sample run of LAB using GPT-6 Luna and Claude Opus 5.5, to assess how LAB's AI graders (Claude Sonnet 4.6 and GPT-5.5) graded outputs from Luna and Opus on the specific criteria at issue, (4) my explanation of the verdict. Harvey task files are cited at commit `1dd81403`.

1. Assess Reasonableness of Staffing Levels on Litigation Invoice (C-049)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **Calculates budget overage percentage as approximately 17%.** PASS if the memo calculates the percentage by which the attorney fee subtotal ($193,372.50) exceeds the approved budget ceiling ($165,000) as approximately 17% (exact figure is 17.2%). FAIL if no percentage overage calculation is provided or if the percentage stated is materially incorrect (off by more than 2 percentage points).
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-049, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error, deficiency in task environment
Task environment	Defective: the invoice's 117 time entries add up to $215,680.00, while its summary and subtotal show $193,372.50.
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: fail
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. The rubric is testing the AI on a specific percentage calculation from an invoice, but the document in the environment is internally inconsistent. The invoice's summary page and its subtotal row show fees of $193,372.50 (17.2% over the $165,000 budget), but the 117 detailed time entries add up to $215,680.00, which puts the overage at $50,680, or 30.7% (13.5 points from the rubric's required 17.2% answer and far outside the 2-point tolerance).

2. Categorize Document Production Set by Relevance and Privilege — Privilege Log and Relevance Classification Report (C-012)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **ISSUE_003: DOC_012 identified as Partially Privileged.** PASS if DOC_012 (chandrasekaran-meeting-notes-aug28.docx, Chandrasekaran's handwritten meeting notes from August 28, 2023) is classified as Partially Privileged. FAIL if classified as fully Privileged or Not Privileged.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-012, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — low-quality professional judgment, rubric is incorrect
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. The rubric is wrong because it fails fully Privileged, which is the better answer here (even if Partially Privileged is defensible).

- The documents are handwritten lawyer notes from a fictitious meeting discussing problems with the R&D Department. The headings on individual topics seem intended to create the impression that there is a discussion of business topics (which would not be privileged) followed by a separate discussion of legal topics (privileged), so from a superficial glance, the rubric does seem to match the topic headings. However, the bullets under each heading make clear that the entire meeting is just dedicated to the topic of the company's desire to find a way to fire the head of R&D without getting sued. The business topics (which look to be nonprivileged) are discussions of how the R&D department is a bit of a disaster, such that management wants to fire the head. The legal sections then involve discussion of the fact that the R&D head has some sort of environmental whistleblower status, so termination is likely to trigger a lawsuit/whistleblower retaliation claim.

- The meeting was specifically convened because outside counsel was concerned about the retaliation claim, and even some of the 'ops' sections that are supposed to be nonprivileged reflect counsel's advice, so they cannot be cleanly treated as nonlegal business discussions.
- While partially privileged might be defensible, my preferred answer would be fully privileged, which the rubric incorrectly fails.

3. Compare Document Production Against Discovery Requests — Discovery Gap Analysis Memorandum (C-029)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **ISSUE_011: Notes only 5 documents actually relate to counterclaim damages.** PASS if the memorandum notes that only 5 of the 14 documents coded to RFP 27 (MLC-004056 through MLC-004102) actually relate to Pacific Corridor's volume shortfall and the counterclaim damages calculation, meaning the counterclaim damages support is thin. FAIL if this is not noted.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-029, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error, rubric is incorrect
Task environment	Defective: the production index codes 15 rows to RFP 27, but its summary tab gives a count of 14 for a range that contains 13.
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: fail

My analysis. This task requires models to make the point that "only" five documents in the bundle "actually relate to Pacific Corridor's volume shortfall and the counterclaim damages calculation, meaning the counterclaim damages support is thin." This rubric is flawed on multiple levels.

- First, it overlooks MLC-003781, a sixth document that plainly relates to the volume shortfall, so the count is objectively wrong (and the agents pointed to several other examples, at least some of which also seem to fit within the stated criteria). There is a document in the bundle that claims that only five documents concern the volume shortfall, but that assertion is undercut by other evidence supplied in the environment.
- Second, this rubric is someone's argumentative characterization of the documents and probably would not hold up under adversarial testing. For example, there is case law that the term "relate to" is fairly broad and flexible, so quite plausibly a number of other documents would apply.
- Third, the premise underlying this rubric–that "only" five documents is such "thin" evidence that it must be called out–is wrong. Even one document could constitute conclusive proof of damages (the general rule is that damages only need to be reasonably estimated; courts do not require great precision); to my mind, this is actually quite a lot of evidence at the fact stage compared to what one would normally see.

4. Draft Case Assessment Memorandum — Litigation Risk Analysis for Distribution Agreement Dispute (C-025)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **ISSUE_007: Recommends motion to dismiss on unjust enrichment.** PASS if the memo recommends filing a motion to dismiss (or motion for judgment on the pleadings, or similar dispositive motion) targeting the unjust enrichment claim (Count IV) on the ground that an express contract governs the parties' relationship. FAIL if no such motion recommendation is made regarding the unjust enrichment claim.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-025, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — low-quality professional judgment, rubric is incorrect
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: fail
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. A different rubric on this task concludes that plaintiff has a strong breach of contract claim. (See id: C-006.) The prompt instructs models to review case documents and "prepare a comprehensive case assessment memo," and models are dinged on this rubric if they do not "recommend[] filing a motion to dismiss" on the unjust enrichment claim, which is expressly pled in the alternative to the (strong) breach of contract claim.

- The rubric is wrong because a careful litigator could reasonably conclude that a motion to dismiss that claim is not a good idea: Count IV is pleaded in the alternative (Complaint ¶127) and seeks restitution of "no less than $22,521,312.50" (¶135), which is exactly the Count I contract damages ($17,721,312.50, ¶94) plus the Count III trade-secret damages ($4,800,000, ¶120). Counts I and III would survive the motion and double recovery is barred, so dismissing Count IV would not reduce the defendant's net exposure; and the factual underpinnings of both claims are the same so a successful motion would not reduce the scope of discovery. Filing a dispositive motion is costly and, on these facts, there seems to be no benefit to doing so. So the required recommendation would fail many thoughtful analyses that could discuss the pros and cons and recommend against filing such a motion.

5. Draft Conflict Check Memorandum for Litigation Engagement Clearance (C-030)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **ISSUE_005: Recommends screening or removal of Caleb Strand.** PASS if the memo recommends that Caleb Strand be screened from the engagement or removed from the proposed staffing. FAIL if no such recommendation is made.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-030, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — low-quality professional judgment, rubric is incorrect
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. The rubric requires the model to recommend that an associate who shares an apartment with his sister (an in-house IP paralegal at TriPoint, the adverse party) be screened from the matter. Screening is generally used in certain specific situations where required by the professional conduct rules, but no rule requires screening in this scenario.

- I agree that a prudent memo would flag the fact that a junior team member is sharing an apartment with an employee of the adverse party, but that is covered by other rubrics (C-026 through C-029). This rubric specifically fails the work product (and results in a 0 for all work on this task) even if the model recommended, say, obtaining the client's informed consent, which would be perfectly permissible and appropriate here.
- Other rubrics in this task resolve similar kinds of conflicts with informed consent (C-024 accepts "clearance with conditions (such as obtaining informed consent)" for Lisa Chow's spousal conflict, and C-016 recommends informed consent for the Ridgeline conflict). Accordingly, informed consent plus a home confidentiality protocol could suffice as an alternative to screening.

6. Draft Conflict Check Memorandum for Litigation Engagement Clearance (C-049)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **ISSUE_011: Recommends integrating annual disclosure questionnaires with ConflictTracker.** PASS if the memo recommends that annual conflict-disclosure questionnaires be cross-referenced with or integrated into the ConflictTracker system. FAIL if no recommendation about integrating disclosure questionnaires with the conflicts database is made.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-049, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — requires specific outputs not expressly or impliedly requested in the prompt
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. The assignment in the prompt is to draft a "comprehensive conflict check memorandum for the proposed engagement." The rubric requires that the memo contain suggested firm-wide process improvements (memo must "recommend[] that annual conflict-disclosure questionnaires be cross-referenced with or integrated into the ConflictTracker system"). That's simply not the

assignment, and there's many reasons why it's undesirable to jam broad process suggestions into a conflicts memo for one specific case. This rubric actually failed work product from Luna that did everything a clearance memo needs on this point. The two judges split on that same Luna memo (Sonnet 4.6 failed it; GPT-5.5 passed it), which shows the criterion does not grade reliably.

7. Draft Counterclaim Against Plaintiff for Breach of Joint Development Agreement (C-045)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **Count: Patent Infringement (ISSUE_005).** PASS if the counterclaim includes a separate count for patent infringement under 35 U.S.C. § 271, alleging that the LumiSense 400 infringes U.S. Patent No. 11,234,567 covering the SensorCore™ architecture. FAIL if no patent infringement counterclaim is asserted.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-045, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Arguable
Task environment	Defective: the record lacks the patent the counterclaim must plead, and the two expert reports give different titles for it.
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. The task is to draft a counterclaim based on a handful of documents (including an expert report, some emails, and a counterclaim strategy memo that another lawyer prepared). The rubric dings the AI if the counterclaims do not include "a separate count for patent infringement under 35 U.S.C. § 271, alleging that the LumiSense 400 infringes U.S. Patent No. 11,234,567."

- The environment does not contain the allegedly infringed patent, which one would need to review in order to have a sufficient basis for drafting that counterclaim, so this environment appears to be incomplete. That said, a defensible approach might be for the agent to draft the counterclaim but flag in brackets that it requires verification.

8. Draft Counterclaim Against Plaintiff for Breach of Joint Development Agreement (C-046)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **Patent Infringement Count: Patent Number Cited.** PASS if the patent infringement count specifically identifies U.S. Patent No. 11,234,567. FAIL if the patent number is omitted or incorrect in the patent infringement count.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-046, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Arguable
Task environment	Defective: same task environment as item 7.
AI auditors' reasoning	Partly correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. Same issue as prior rubric. This one is essentially derivative because it depends on pleading the patent count that was required in the prior rubric.

9. Draft Case Assessment Memorandum for Defective Industrial Equipment Product Liability Claim (C-003)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **Executive Summary mentions death of Marco Reyes.** PASS if the Executive Summary mentions the death of Marco Reyes. FAIL if the fatality is not mentioned in the Executive Summary.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-003, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — requires specific outputs not expressly or impliedly requested in the prompt
Task environment	Defective: same task environment as item 10 (Ohio state agency issuing OSHA citations).
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: fail
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: fail

My analysis. The case involved a (fictitious) safety incident at a manufacturing plant that killed one employee and seriously injured two others. The rubric requires the fact that one employee died be discussed specifically in the "executive summary." When we tested Opus 5.5 and GPT-6 Luna on this benchmark, both discussed the death in several places in their memo, especially the factual background section, but the executive summary consisted of an overview of the legal analysis that did not restate the fact of the death. They were failed by one or more judges.

- This fails perfectly competent and appropriate work product. The company CEO who retained counsel to advise on this incident is the same person who delivered news of the (fictitious) tragic death to the decedent's widow and surviving family members, so the most senior management of the company is obviously very familiar with the incident and the agents' approach of focusing the executive summary on the legal exposure is appropriate.
- The two judges reached opposite results on Luna's memo: GPT-5.5 failed it, while Sonnet 4.6 passed it only by quoting a sentence from the memo's facts section as if it appeared in the executive summary.

10. Draft Case Assessment Memorandum for Defective Industrial Equipment Product Liability Claim (C-026)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **OSHA LOTO citation identified with specific violation and penalty.** PASS if the memo identifies the OSHA serious citation for LOTO deficiency under 29 CFR 1910.147(c)(4)(i) with a penalty of $18,900. FAIL if this specific citation, regulation, or penalty amount is not referenced.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-026, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Not defective — defective environment, but rubric does not fail correct work product
Task environment	Defective: Ohio's Division of Safety & Hygiene cannot issue OSHA citations to this private employer. The criterion itself does not misgrade work (environment-only defect).
AI auditors' reasoning	Wrong
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: fail
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. Although the specific rubric being tested does not fail work product incorrectly, the environment is defective in an unintended way. The environment contains an OSHA citation from Ohio's Division of Safety & Hygiene. But Ohio does not have an OSHA-approved State Plan, so only federal regulators have jurisdiction to issue OSHA citations against this company. The environment does not test that so it is not being presented as a "mistake" by one's adversary that the agents should pick up on.

- The rubric itself is not wrong because it simply wants a memo to address the purported citation, so an agent could write the memo while noticing that the task is obviously a fictitious evaluation with an incoherent environment.

11. Draft Discovery Plan Memorandum for Breach of Contract and Fraud Defense (C-036)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **Provides custodian priority rankings.** PASS if the memo provides priority rankings or tiers for custodians (e.g., high/medium/low priority, or Tier 1/Tier 2, or similar prioritization). FAIL if custodians are listed without any indication of relative priority.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-036, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Not defective
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Wrong
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. The AI agent is right that the rubric is really enforcing a stylistic choice, but the choice here is well-grounded in convention and an appropriate expectation for quality work product. The case file contains a court order where the judge encouraged the parties to discuss whether phased discovery would be appropriate at the Rule 26(f) conference, and there is some existing prioritization work in the environment. The rubric requires that the agent's discovery plan include some kind of prioritization or phasing of custodians, which is a common expectation in these cases. I think it's fair to judge anything that lacks any form of prioritization as deficient given the context.

12. Draft Federal Complaint for Breach of Contract and Fiduciary Duty — Placement Agent Dispute (C-025)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **ISSUE_012: Complaint requests injunctive relief.** PASS if the prayer for relief includes a request for preliminary and/or permanent injunctive relief — specifically to enforce the non-solicitation provision and prevent Graydon from continuing to divert Fund III investor prospects to competing funds. FAIL if no injunctive relief is requested.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-025, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Not defective
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Wrong

LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. The client intake memo specifically describes an interest in seeking injunctive relief ("We may also wish to seek preliminary and permanent injunctive relief to enforce the twelve-month non-solicitation tail"), and the client's demand letter threatens it. While it's true that the intake memo flags the topic for discussion, the correct approach is to include the proposed prayer for relief in the draft, so the case team can see how it reads and discuss any downsides. As a practical matter, there's unlikely to be much downside to including this prayer for relief in the complaint. (Whether it's worth the cost of actually pursuing a preliminary injunction on this is debatable, so the rubric's approach makes sense.)

13. Draft First Set of Interrogatories to Defendant Veridian Health Systems in Trade Secret Misappropriation Case (C-008)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **Definitions section defines 'Document' or 'Documents'.** PASS if the Definitions section includes a definition of 'Document' or 'Documents' that is broad enough to encompass electronically stored information (ESI), emails, and physical documents. FAIL if there is no definition of 'Document' or it is so narrow as to exclude electronic records.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-008, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error, rubric is incorrect
Task environment	Defective: the supplied documents mischaracterize or miscite case law (citation sweep; peripheral to this criterion).
AI auditors' reasoning	Partly correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: fail
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. The rubric fails any draft that does not supply a definition of "document" encompassing electronically stored information (ESI). There are two problems:

- First, these are interrogatories, not document requests. Well-drafted interrogatories do not necessarily need to use the word "document." The rubric does not really make sense as a requirement for this kind of work product.
- Second, even if we were dealing with document requests here (which we are not), the local rules of many courts, including the Western District of Texas (where this fictitious case is being litigated), define the term "document" for all discovery requests served by litigants in those cases. There is thus no requirement to define the term "documents," and in fact, supplying a definition could just trigger objections from the other side that the local rule controls. See Local Rule CV-26, available at https://www.txwd.uscourts.gov/court-information/lcr-civil-rules/ ("The term 'document' means any document or electronically stored information as described in Federal Rule of Civil Procedure 34(a). A draft of a nonidentical copy is a separate document within the meaning of this term.").
- The rubric does demonstrably fail rules-compliant work product. For example, Luna was failed for not including a definition of the term "Document" but that's actually what the local rules encourage in this Court.

14. Draft First Set of Interrogatories to Defendant Veridian Health Systems in Trade Secret Misappropriation Case (C-026)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **Interrogatory re: USB drive or CMT files on Veridian systems.** PASS if at least one interrogatory asks whether Oshiro's USB drive (referencing serial number CX-8827491 or otherwise describing the external storage device) was ever connected to, accessed from, or present on any Veridian system, device, or network, or asks whether any CMT files or materials were ever possessed, accessed, viewed, or copied by Veridian or its employees. FAIL if no interrogatory addresses the USB drive or CMT files on Veridian systems.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-026, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Not defective
Task environment	Defective: same task environment as item 13 (environment-only defect).
AI auditors' reasoning	Wrong
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. This one does not really belong on the list, as GPT-6 Sol was complaining about a different rubric (C-048) which it argues is inconsistent with this one. It does not identify any issue in this rubric, standing alone, so this counts as an instance where Sol added something to the "flagged" list that does not belong.

15. Draft Discovery Responses and Objections to RFAs and RFPs in Breach of Supply Agreement Litigation (C-028)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **ISSUE_011: Identifies RFA No. 20 as calling for a legal conclusion.** PASS if the plan identifies that RFA No. 20 (asking Prismavale to admit the products were 'not merchantable as defined by the Uniform Commercial Code') calls for a legal conclusion regarding UCC § 2-314 merchantability and recommends objecting on that basis. FAIL if the plan does not identify the legal conclusion problem with RFA No. 20.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-028, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — low-quality professional judgment, rubric is incorrect
Task environment	Defective: the supplied Answer cites complaint paragraph ranges that do not match the complaint (e.g. Count III as ¶¶ 88–94; the complaint's Count III is ¶¶ 86–96).
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: fail
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. Plaintiff served a request for admission on the defendant that says, "Admit that the SB-102 and PS-302 products shipped by Prismavale to Greenleaf were not merchantable as defined by the Uniform Commercial Code." The prompt asks the agent to "prepare a discovery strategy memo and formal RFA/RFP responses." The rubric requires "the plan" (i.e., the strategy memo) to recommend objecting to the request on the grounds that it calls for a legal conclusion. The rubric is wrong for two main reasons:

- First, the modern view is requests for admissions can call for application of law to facts. While it is within acceptable professional norms for a lawyer to object on the ground that such a request calls for a legal conclusion, and then proceed to answer, the better reading of the law is that this request is not objectionable such that the party should simply answer. On this legal conclusion in particular, there's really no reason why one would prefer to object rather than simply deny the requested admission. So this rubric fails competent work product (and

probably the better answer than the one the rubric calls for).

- Second, even assuming one should include the objection at all, the task fails the model if the issue is not expressly addressed in the strategy memo. Luna made the "legal conclusion" objection in the draft responses and then proceeded to a substantive denial (an acceptable approach), but did not discuss the "legal conclusion" objection in the memo. That was judged a failure. That's really requiring duplicative responses on a very minor point that probably shouldn't be in the drafts at all.

16. Draft Motion in Limine to Exclude Expert Testimony and Prejudicial Evidence in Commercial Breach of Contract Case (C-009)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **ISSUE_004: Identifies the $11,000 arithmetic discrepancy.** PASS if the motion identifies that the sum of Marchetti's five itemized damages categories totals $14,211,000, but her report states total damages as $14,200,000, creating an $11,000 discrepancy. FAIL if this arithmetic error is not identified.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-009, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — low-quality professional judgment, rubric is incorrect (a judgment call, not an objective error); defective environment (directs advocacy outside professional norms); companion rubric C-010 also incorrect (not sampled)
Task environment	Defective: the task directs advocacy outside professional norms (an $11,000 rounding point offered as a *Daubert* ground) and labels a rounding difference an "arithmetic error."
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. The damages expert includes a summary table in her report listing various items of damages, which collectively add up to $14,211,000; the Total Damages line lists the total as $14,200,000. Opposing counsel questioned the expert about it at her deposition, and the expert calls it "a rounding discrepancy." An internal strategy memo highlights the issue as a ground for seeking to exclude the expert's testimony under *Daubert*, arguing "the arithmetic error supports a cumulative argument that the report was prepared without the rigor required of expert testimony in federal court."

- This task is poorly specified, and the recommended strategy of raising this with the judge is a poor one:
- First, the task environment repeatedly calls this an "arithmetic error." At her deposition the expert attributed it to rounding, and the table reads that way: the total is rounded to the nearest $100,000. That is somewhat unorthodox in an expert report (particularly since it is written out as $14,200,000 rather than $14.2 million), but numbers are often rounded in court filings, and a judge is unlikely to treat a rounded total as an error in the analysis.
- Second, even if the gap were an error rather than rounding, an $11,000 discrepancy in a $14.2

million calculation is generally not a basis for excluding the expert's testimony under *Daubert*. At most one could move to exclude the erroneous version and ask for more accurate testimony, but that does nothing to help the hypothetical client here; it just raises their damages exposure by the $11,000 that the expert was willing to round off.

- Third, the strategy memo offers the point only as a cumulative one, and the framing around it is a poor fit for a federal judge. The memo wants the motion to argue that the expert's 30 prior engagements were "in state courts and arbitrations that do not impose the same methodological gatekeeping requirements" as federal courts. Some state courts do use the *Frye* standard instead of *Daubert*, but an argument that state courts do not observe adequate methodological rigor is not one most federal judges will receive well. And a motion that spends the court's time on a rounding difference signals that the movant had no better argument, which weakens the motion's real points.
- This rubric is scored as Defective, as a professional-judgment call rather than an objective error. My view is that the better approach is to drop this issue entirely, and the sampled rubric (C-009) fails a motion that does so, even though a motion that merely mentions the discrepancy in a footnote would pass. The companion rubric, C-010, is in my view objectively wrong because it requires that this issue be presented as a basis for excluding the expert's testimony under *Daubert*. Luna was failed incorrectly on C-010 (by the Sonnet 4.6 judge) for downplaying this issue; in fact, Luna was right to do so, as it should not be raised at all. But since that's not the sampled criterion, we do not mark it here.

17. Draft Rule 12(b)(6) Motion to Dismiss Brief — Commercial Software Licensing Dispute (C-037)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **ISSUE_008 — Cites Delaware parol evidence authority.** PASS if the motion brief cites relevant Delaware authority on the parol evidence rule and integration clauses, such as SIGA Technologies v. PharmAthene or Eagle Industries v. DeVilbiss Health Care. FAIL if no Delaware parol evidence authority is cited.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-037, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error (including hallucinations), rubric is incorrect
Task environment	Defective: the supplied research memo cites fabricated or mischaracterized authority (citation sweep: 28 of 53 citations in this task have problems).
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: fail
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: fail

My analysis. The rubric here involves a legal error, and the task environment contains hallucinations about case law. This one is extremely defective for multiple reasons:

- First, the rubric is demanding case law on the wrong legal doctrine. Under Delaware law, the parol evidence rule and an integration clause do not preclude fraud claims. The issue

here is whether the plaintiff can reasonably allege that they relied on their counterparty's pre-signing representations despite their agreement in the contract that they were not relying on any representations other than those written in the contract itself.

- Second, the cases in the environment appear to contain multiple hallucinations. The rubric refers to SIGA v. PharmAthene, but Opus noted that case does not address integration or parol evidence. The task environment contains a legal research memo that cites *SIGA Technologies, Inc. v. PharmAthene, Inc.*, 67 A.3d 330 (Del. 2013), and claims that it states (at page 344), "an integration clause is the clearest declaration that the parties intend the writing to be the complete and final expression of their agreement." The quoted language does not appear in the cited case. Page 344 of that case addresses the duty to negotiate in good faith, not integration clauses. Similarly, the memo cites *Eagle Industries, Inc. v. DeVilbiss Health Care, Inc.*, 702 A.2d 1228 (Del. 1997) and says: "The Delaware Supreme Court held that 'a party to a contract cannot promise, in a clear integration clause of a negotiated agreement, that it is not relying on promises or representations made by the other party outside of the agreement, and then assert a claim for fraud based on those very representations.' *Id.* at 1232." The quoted language does not appear in the cited case.
- Third, the rubric failed responses that stated the correct law on this point. In our tests, Opus reviewed SIGA and Eagle, correctly realized they were inapposite and declined to cite them, cited more on-point and accurate authority, and was then failed for doing a better job than the rubric's author did at this task.

18. Draft Rule 12(b)(6) Motion to Dismiss Brief — Commercial Software Licensing Dispute (C-045)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **ISSUE_010 — References Arcadia's own delays contributing to Go-Live delay.** PASS if the motion brief identifies Arcadia's own contributing failures, including the 45-day Project Manager gap (Kevin Liu's departure) and/or the 75-day late API specifications, as causes of the Go-Live delay. FAIL if Arcadia's own contributory delays are not mentioned.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-045, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error, rubric is incorrect
Task environment	Defective: same task environment as item 17.
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct

LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: fail
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: fail

My analysis. The rubric demands that the brief argue a factual dispute on a motion to dismiss, where the court takes the plaintiff's well-pleaded allegations as true. The 45-day and 75-day delays come from the defendant's internal status report. The complaint references that report, so a court could consider it, but the complaint disputes the report's account of causation, and a referenced document cannot be credited over the complaint's contrary allegations at the pleading stage. Moreover, courts generally cannot resolve messy fact disputes over "causation" on a motion to dismiss.

- The criterion failed agents that correctly recognized that this argument was outside the scope of what can be argued on a motion to dismiss and thus decided to exclude it. Both briefs also failed many other criteria on this task (by judge, 29 and 30 for Luna; 19 and 21 for Opus), so correcting this criterion alone would not have passed either task under all-pass scoring.

19. Draft Verified Responses and Objections to Plaintiff's First Set of Interrogatories in Commercial Breach of Contract and Fraud Action (C-028)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **Correct financial figures for Tri-Basin purchase history.** PASS if any purchase history figures cited in the responses are consistent with the canonical data: 2015: $9.2M; 2016: $10.1M; 2017: $10.8M; 2018: $12.4M; 2019: $13.6M; 2020: $9.7M; 2021: $15.3M; 2022: $16.8M; 2023 (Jan–Aug): $11.9M. Minor rounding differences are acceptable. Also PASS if the response invokes Rule 33(d) rather than citing specific figures. FAIL if specific purchase figures are cited but are materially incorrect.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-028, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error, deficiency in task environment; rubric is incorrect
Task environment	Defective: the purchase-history spreadsheet is internally inconsistent (three 2020 series; line items that do not sum to subtotals), and the record has no contract-year data.
AI auditors' reasoning	Partly correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. There are two issues:

- First, Interrogatory No. 4(b) asks for Tri-Basin's actual purchases for the 2020 contract year (the contract year runs from January 15 through January 14 of the following year; Interrogatory No. 14 separately asks for calendar-year totals), but the canonical data referred to in the rubric is calendar year data, so the rubric's numbers are not correct for that request. The correct value cannot be discerned from the environment: the monthly data cannot be split at January 15, and nothing in the record supports assuming purchases are spread evenly within January (seasonal variation would make that unlikely). The rubric therefore grades wrong in the opposite direction from most of the other items: rather than failing good work product, it passes responses that supply the calendar-year figure for a contract-year request without acknowledging that the record does not contain the requested data. That is approving fundamentally deficient work product.
- Second, the data that is provided has some internal inconsistencies. For example, an "annual summary" tab lists 2020 purchases at $9.7 million, but the monthly detail lists 2020 three times, with totals of $8,700,000, $8,549,400 and $9,700,000. The units sold do not match up between those two sheets for 2021, 2022, 2023, and series 3 of 2020. One of the monthly rows does not add up (gross $1,210,000 + credits −$17,400 = $1,192,600, but the net shown is $1,192,500). The annual summary minimums do not add up. In the Product Line Breakdown, line-item net revenue never sums to the subtotal. So a response that relied on the line items

would get graded as a failure.

- The environment contains law firm discovery guidelines that recommend that interrogatory responses match the client's Answer, but the Answer here contains only approximate figures, which is consistent with the Answer using calendar year data as a rough approximation instead of providing the contract year data requested.

20. Extract Key Obligations from Litigation Hold and Document Preservation Notice — Obligation Summary Memorandum (C-002)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **ISSUE_001: Flags financial records date discrepancy as requiring DOJ clarification.** PASS if the memo recommends seeking clarification from the DOJ regarding the conflicting date ranges (Jan 1, 2017 vs. Jan 1, 2019) for financial records. FAIL if no recommendation to seek clarification is made.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-002, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error, rubric is incorrect
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct

LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: fail
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: fail

My analysis. The task involves a document preservation notice from federal criminal authorities that defines the relevant period (for which the recipient must preserve documents) as January 1, 2019, through March 3, 2025 "unless otherwise specified herein." For one specific category of documents, the notice states that, "Notwithstanding the Relevant Period defined in Paragraph 12 of this Notice, Ridgeline shall preserve [certain kinds of] records . . . from January 1, 2017 to the present date."

- The rubric suggests that the agent should seek clarification of the "conflicting" date ranges but there is no conflict. The notice quite clearly imposed a longer period for one specific category of documents, while all the other categories are subject to a shorter period. This is a fairly common request.
- Luna was failed by both judges for reading the notice correctly. Opus was failed by one judge and passed by the other, on the strength of an unrelated recommendation to clarify a category-numbering inconsistency with the DOJ. The criterion makes no sense.

21. Identify Excessive or Duplicative Research Charges in Litigation Invoice (C-013)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **Issue 3: Identifies duplicative MTCA research across Takahashi and Wendt.** PASS if the memo identifies that multiple attorneys (Kenji Takahashi and Tyler Wendt) billed for overlapping MTCA liability/contractor liability/summary judgment research during July 2024, citing Section 6.4 (Duplicative Research Prohibition). FAIL if the

MTCA duplication across timekeepers is not identified.

— Harvey LAB, criterion C-013, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Not defective
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Wrong
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. While Sol is right that the facts here are insufficient to establish that the client's billing guidelines were violated, for purposes of the task (a client-side memo identifying changes to dispute), it seems reasonable to flag that multiple attorneys were doing research into closely related issues. The task requested "a memo identifying all non-compliant or excessive charges with recommended adjustments," so flagging potential violations (even if they were not clearly proven from the face of the time entries) is a standard approach a client would take here.

22. Identify Issues in Litigation Matter Budget Proposal (C-029)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

Budget inconsistency rated as Critical or High severity. PASS if the fee total reconciliation discrepancy ($116,050 difference between phase-based and staffing-model totals) is assigned a severity of Critical or High (or the highest or second-highest tier in whatever severity scale is used). FAIL if it is assigned a lower severity level or no severity level.

— Harvey LAB, criterion C-029, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Arguable — requires specific outputs not expressly or impliedly requested in the prompt
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. The prompt requested "a categorized issue memorandum" but didn't specify what the categories should be. The rubric fails the model if it does not break issues into severity levels or it does not assign a critical or high severity level to a specific issue. While it appears that models often do volunteer this kind of severity assessment, it's not requested by the prompt and competent work product could decline to include it.

23. Review Counterparty's Proposed Jury Instructions — Issue Memorandum for Trade Secrets Trial (C-020)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **Explains distinction between tortious interference with contract vs. business relations.** PASS if the memo explains that under Georgia law, tortious interference with an existing contract does not require a separately/independently wrongful act — the knowing inducement of the breach is sufficient — and that the 'independently wrongful act' element applies to the distinct tort of tortious interference with business relations. FAIL if this legal distinction is not articulated.
>
> — Harvey LAB, criterion C-020, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error (including hallucinations), rubric is incorrect
Task environment	Defective: the fictional summary-judgment order cites a case for the opposite of its holding and a case that cannot be found (citation sweep: 10 of 21 citations in this task have problems).
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: fail
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: fail; GPT-5.5 judge: fail

My analysis. Multiple issues:

- First, this is a clear legal error. Georgia applies the same elements to interference with contractual and business relations. The rubric says the opposite of what Georgia law is. *Disaster Services, Inc. v. ERC P'ship*, 228 Ga. App. 739, 740–41 (1997) ("Tortious interference claims, whether asserting interference with contractual relations, business relations, or potential business relations, share certain common essential elements: (1) improper action or wrongful conduct by the defendant without privilege; (2) the defendant acted purposely and with malice with the intent to injure; (3) the defendant induced a breach of contractual obligations or caused a party or third parties to discontinue or fail to enter into an anticipated business relationship with the plaintiff; and (4) the defendant's tortious conduct proximately caused damage to the plaintiff.").
- Second, the fictional summary judgment order (from which the rubric's legal position seems to be taken) appears to contain several hallucinations. For example, the order paraphrases the third and fourth element described in *Disaster Services* approximately correctly, but the first two elements are erroneously listed as "(1) the existence of a valid contract between the plaintiff and a third party; (2) the defendant's knowledge of the contract." The fictional order also cites *Valdosta Livestock, Inc. v. Furst*, 342 Ga. App. 25, 28 (2017), which is not found in any legal databases.

24. Review Litigation Invoice Against Outside Counsel Billing Guidelines — Compliance Deviation Report (C-024)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

> **Recommends full disallowance of black car service: $387.00.** PASS if the

report recommends disallowing the full $387.00 for black car service (or reducing it to a reasonable taxi/ride-share equivalent). FAIL if no disallowance or reduction is recommended.

— Harvey LAB, criterion C-024, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Not defective
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Wrong

LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. The billing guidelines state that "Reimbursable ground transportation is limited to ride-share ... or taxi" and "Limousine services and black car services are not reimbursable under any circumstances." Sol's critique of the rubric is that the policy requires disallowing black car reimbursement, not reducing the reimbursement amount to what a taxi or ride share would have cost. The rubric's interpretation (that either disallowing the expense entirely or capping reimbursement at the amount a taxi would have cost) seems reasonable and closer to the likely real-world application of a policy like this.

25. Review Litigation Invoice Against Outside Counsel Billing Guidelines — Compliance Deviation Report (C-042)

Quoted from Harvey LAB

Classifies business class airfare as borderline/requires discussion. PASS if the report classifies the business class airfare issue (Messina's $2,847.00 flight) as a borderline or 'requires discussion' issue rather than a clear-cut mandatory reduction, given the 4-hour-20-minute flight duration and the 4-hour threshold. FAIL if it is classified as a clear mandatory reduction without acknowledging the ambiguity, OR if it is entirely dismissed as compliant.

— Harvey LAB, criterion C-042, task file at commit `1dd81403`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error, rubric is incorrect
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct

LAB's own grading of two model runs (Harvey's judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass
Claude Opus 5.5	Sonnet 4.6 judge: pass; GPT-5.5 judge: pass

My analysis. The rubric's analysis is wrong. The travel policy included in the environment states, "For domestic flights with a scheduled duration of four (4) hours or more, business class may be booked without prior approval." The record does not state the flight's duration (the invoice lists only the route and fare class). The only basis for raising this seems to be in the rubric itself, which says the flight could take 4h20m, but even under that view, there's nothing to discuss, as the policy allows business class for that duration.

E Human review of AI-flagged LegalReasonBench criteria

Sol and Opus each audited the 11 litigation assignments from micro1's public LegalReasonBench sample (dataset revision `1bfa904c`). They flagged a total of 63 criteria (out of the 179 they audited) as problematic or arguably problematic. I then reviewed a simple random sample of 25 of the 63 (seed 20261024, from 9 assignments) under a protocol committed prior to the draw. I applied the same standard as used for the LAB review.

I did not finalize my verdicts until after an adversarial quality-control process in which AI models (Claude Opus 5.5, Claude Fable 5.1, GPT-6 Sol, and GPT-6 Astra) were invited to argue in favor of and against each verdict that I had reached. I updated the documentation after the audit QC process to reflect the standards that I had applied during the audit more faithfully. Most notably, I determined that rubrics that fail an answer a competent lawyer would consider the correct/best answer or a clearly reasonable one should be treated as defective, since they train models to reject reasonable approaches.

The results were that 21 of 25 reviewed rubrics were defective, with 7 of these constituting unambiguous objective errors and the remainder constituting instances where the rubric enforces an unreasonable or inaccurate position on a question of professional judgment. I found that 12 items came from defective environments.

Statistically this analysis implies that, at the 95% confidence level, at least 45 of the criteria that AI models flagged as defective are in fact defective (the point estimate would be 53 defective criteria) and at least 11 are objective errors (point estimate is 18).

Rubric verdict	Environment defective	Environment correct	Total
Defective	10	11	21
Arguable	0	0	0
Not defective	2	2	4
Total	12	13	25

Table 8: My verdicts on the 25 sampled LegalReasonBench criteria, by whether the task environment itself contains a defect.

1. Petition for Writ of Certiorari for Quasi-judicial Proceeding, assignment 1: Legal Memorandum to Board of County Commissioners

criterion `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_dci2018_10023_remained_activ`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Penalty criterion, −15 points.** States in the first assignment that DCI2018-10023 remained active until September 13, 2023.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_dci2018_10023_remained_activ`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 1
LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: clear; Claude Sonnet 5: clear; Gemini 3.8 Flash: clear. Result: penalty not applied (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: fires; Claude Sonnet 5: clear; Gemini 3.8 Flash: clear. Result: penalty not applied (1/3)

My analysis. Confirmed. This rubric penalizes the model if the memo it drafts says that the 2019 zoning case was still pending until September 13, 2023, which is what the task environment indicates (Petition.docx p. 19: "the 2019 zoning case was left open until September 13, 2023").

The rubric's theory is that a county rule, Lee County Admin. Code AC-2-6 § 4.1.B(1), which is not cited in the environment but can be found using web search (which models are allowed to use here), says that remanded hearings must occur within six months and that applications will be considered withdrawn after that. But the rubric ignores that the case is withdrawn only "[i]f the six month deadline is not met because of action or inaction of the Applicant/Appellant." In addition, AC-2-6 § 4.1 is prefaced with a sentence that states that it governs only applications "remanded to the Hearing Examiner by the Board." The case actually concerns a remand from the Hearing Examiner to the staff (Petition.docx: "we jointly request that DCI2018-10023 be remanded back to the staff"), so the regulation does not apply by its terms.

This case appears to be drawn from a real litigation, Spahhn v. Lee County, No. 24-CA-1479 (Fla. 20th Cir. Ct. Oct. 25, 2025) (order granting petition for writ of certiorari), and the plaintiffs' position is that the case remained live to September 13, 2023 (contradicting the rubric); the county says the case was withdrawn in March 2022. Elsewhere the rubric claims the case was withdrawn on February 13, 2020 (companion criterion `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_under_lee_county_fla_admin_c`), but neither party advanced that claim, so the rubric seems to be contradicted by the ground-truth evidence from the litigation.

2. Petition for Writ of Certiorari for Quasi-judicial Proceeding, assignment 1: Legal Memorandum to Board of County Commissioners

criterion `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_the_county_should_cease_cons`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Penalty criterion, −30 points.** States in the first assignment that the County should cease construction activities at the subject property.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_the_county_should_cease_cons`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — professional judgment; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 2
LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: clear; Claude Sonnet 5: clear; Gemini 3.8 Flash: clear. Result: penalty not applied (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: fires; Claude Sonnet 5: fires; Gemini 3.8 Flash: clear. Result: penalty applied (2/3)

My analysis. Confirmed. The rubric deducts 30 points if the memo being prepared for a county in a zoning dispute recommends stopping construction.

The basis of this rubric is Parkway Towers Condominium Ass'n v. Metropolitan Dade County, 295 So. 2d 295 (Fla. 1974) (per curiam), which merely exercises discretion not to hear an appeal on certiorari. While it is true that the outcome in that particular case was that the county was allowed to proceed with construction, the court's reasoning, if anything, undercuts the rubric's reading: "Although we now consider our issuance of the writ of certiorari to have been improvident in this case, which results in our discharge thereof, it is nevertheless our view prospectively that zoning variations to accommodate county or municipal facility purposes should either have been anticipated in zoning ordinances before construction or operation of such facilities is commenced or, if this has not been done, construction should not be undertaken thereof until after due modification or change therefor is made in existing zoning ordinances." Id. at 295–96. In other words, the very case the rubric relies on essentially says the opposite of what it claims and expresses the Florida Supreme Court's view that zoning issues should be fixed before construction occurs.

The fact that some construction has begun is a relevant factor, but nothing in the environment establishes that it would be costly, impossible, or imprudent for the county to stop construction until the zoning issues are fixed properly to comply with the Court's opinion. Many prudent lawyers, relying on the Florida Supreme Court's guidance, might recommend addressing the zoning issue before continuing with construction, so this rubric fails a response many careful lawyers would prefer.

3. Petition for Writ of Certiorari for Quasi-judicial Proceeding, assignment 1: Legal Memorandum to Board of County Commissioners

criterion `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_the_county_should_file_a_tim`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +20 points.** States in the first assignment that the County should file a timely appeal with the 6th District Court of Appeals.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_the_county_should_file_a_tim`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — professional judgment; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 3
LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: met (2/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: met. Result: met (3/3)

My analysis. Rubrics 23 and 24 (criteria `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_the_county_should_file_a_tim` and `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_the_county_should_remand_the`, +20 each) require the government to simultaneously pursue an appeal and remand to a hearing examiner to fix the deficiencies the Court identified. I agree with Sol that the recommendation to take an appeal is not mandatory here and there are very good reasons not to appeal. While a party who loses in the trial court often wishes to appeal, the trial court's ruling here allows the government to reach the same conclusion it originally did after correcting some deficiencies in the process followed the first time. Often simply correcting the deficiencies identified by a trial court would be faster and more reliable for a government to proceed with a project than appealing.

Although the government in the real litigation did elect to simultaneously appeal and remand the issue to the hearing examiner (as the rubric recommends), the government's filing in the appeal acknowledged that the remand might moot the appeal. The government argued the appeal should still be considered because it wanted to undo the trial court's finding that the government had been biased in approving the initial rezoning, but that is a very debatable position (and arguably not a strong basis for an appeal).

The second level of certiorari review is also limited to whether the circuit court afforded procedural due process and applied the correct law, so the appeal appears to be somewhat weak on the merits (or at least not such an obvious winner that a lawyer in this spot would always advise bringing the appeal, rather than just trying to clean up the issues the lower court flagged). *See Haines City Cmty. Dev. v. Heggs*, 658 So. 2d 523, 530 (Fla. 1995). Filing a protective appeal is reasonable and probably the default most lawyers would implement, but in the case of a government entity, simply curing the identified defects on remand may work equally well. So this case does not seem to require an appeal — that's really a judgment call — so the rubric would incorrectly effectively penalize a failure to pursue a strategy many lawyers would advise against.

4. Petition for Writ of Certiorari for Quasi-judicial Proceeding, assignment 1: Legal Memorandum to Board of County Commissioners

criterion `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_the_county_should_remand_the`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +20 points.** States in the first assignment that the County should remand the case to the Hearing Examiner to address the deficiencies identified in the Order Granting Writ of Certiorari while an appeal is pending.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_the_county_should_remand_`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — professional judgment; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 4

LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)

My analysis. With respect to the rubric recommending remand to the hearing officer, I agree with the aspect of it that recommends remand: remand to the Hearing Examiner to fix issues identified by a court is the standard approach a government would follow in this spot. But as written, the criterion requires remand "while an appeal is pending," so it also requires an appeal, and it would therefore reject a remand-only recommendation that a careful litigator could adopt, for the reasons given for criterion 23 (item 3). A memo that recommends remand without an appeal would fail it. Sol flagged it (as arguable) on this same ground.

5. Petition for Writ of Certiorari for Quasi-judicial Proceeding, assignment 1: Legal Memorandum to Board of County Commissioners

criterion `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_under_fla_stat_163_3167_10_2`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +10 points.** States in the first assignment that under Fla. Stat § 163.3167(10) (2025) the development order issued for the project may not be invalidated by a subsequent judicial determination because the timeframe for filing an appeal of the development order has expired.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_under_fla_stat_163_3167_10_2`, rubric at revision 1bfa904c

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 5

LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)

My analysis. This rubric is deeply confused about the meaning of the statutory provision it's relying on. Fla. Stat. § 163.3167(10) (2025) protects the developer and allows a project to continue

in a situation where no one challenges that specific development, but a later case (typically involving a different development) invalidates the regulation under which the first development was approved. In that scenario, the developer whose project was approved (with no one challenging it) is entitled to proceed notwithstanding the fact that the regulations the first developer relied on were later invalidated in a *different* case. That principle has no relevance here, where the project at issue was timely challenged by a petition for a writ of certiorari, and a court invalidated the approval for the specific project that was timely challenged.

The statute also applies only when a later court decision rules the land development regulations themselves "invalid because of a deficiency in the approval standards." That is not what occurred here. The circuit court quashed the rezoning after finding defects in the Board's specific decision here, but did not invalidate Lee County's regulations. So even if the criterion were read to refer to some later development order issued under the rezoning, § 163.3167(10) would not address it.

6. Petition for Writ of Certiorari for Quasi-judicial Proceeding, assignment 1: Legal Memorandum to Board of County Commissioners

criterion `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_under_lee_county_fla_admin_c`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +5 points.** States in the first assignment that under Lee County, Fla. Admin. Code § 2-6, 4.1 B. (2025), DCI2018-10023 was considered withdrawn on February 13, 2020.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `states_in_the_first_assignment_that_under_lee_county_fla_admin_c`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 6

LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)

My analysis. Wrong for the same reasons as item 1. Neither party in the actual litigation contends that the six-month deadline was missed "because of action or inaction of the Applicant/Appellant." There's nothing in the environment to support that claim, and without a factual predicate for that, there's no factual basis for suggesting that Lee County Admin. Code AC-2-6 § 4.1.B(1) (2025) applies here. In addition, AC-2-6 § 4.1 is prefaced with a sentence that states that it governs only applications "remanded to the Hearing Examiner by the Board." The case actually concerns a remand from the Hearing Examiner to the staff (Petition.docx: "we jointly request that DCI2018-10023 be remanded back to the staff"), so the regulation does not apply by its terms.

7. Petition for Writ of Certiorari for Quasi-judicial Proceeding, assignment 2: Brief Requesting Second-Tier Review

criterion `states_in_the_second_assignment_that_expert_testimony_on_the_rec`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +5 points.** States in the second assignment that expert testimony on the record is competent substantial evidence that supports the Board's approval of the rezoning.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `states_in_the_second_assignment_that_expert_testimony_on_the_rec`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Not defective
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Wrong
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 7

LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)

My analysis. Correct as written. Sol initially suggested that this rubric was arguably defective, because it rewards models for making the point that the expert testimony in the record can support the Board's zoning approval. Sol's concern was that the expert testimony is not actually in the environment provided. While Sol correctly points out that the testimony is not in the environment, the Petition quotes portions of the testimony with citations to the transcripts, and other material in the environment does make clear that expert analysis was used to support the Board's decision. It's a relatively uncontroversial proposition, the relevance of which can be readily inferred from the environment, and my view is that any competent lawyer would consider adding that point (at least briefly) an improvement to the analysis.

8. Petition for Writ of Certiorari for Quasi-judicial Proceeding, assignment 2: Brief Requesting Second-Tier Review

criterion `states_in_the_second_assignment_that_the_staff_report_recommendi`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +5 points.** States in the second assignment that the staff report recommending approval is competent substantial evidence that supports the Board's approval of the rezoning.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `states_in_the_second_assignment_that_the_staff_report_recommendi`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Not defective
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Wrong
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 8

LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)

My analysis. Correct as written. This is a similar issue to item 7. The rubric wants models to make the point that the staff report is evidence supporting the Board's approval. Sol says the underlying staff report is not part of the environment, but it is referenced in other documents, and any competent lawyer in this situation would want the fact that such a report exists to be cited, as it's clearly going to be important evidence in support of the government's position.

9. Viability of a DCCA Challenge, assignment 1: Record Mapping: Final Notice Against Award

criterion `criterion_8`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +28 points.** Identifies that the comparator memorandum's stated coverage years conflict with the dates of the cases it summarizes.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_8`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Defective: Award ¶ 7 says "Two of the four comparators involved on-duty conduct," but the comparator memorandum shows three on duty (Guzman, Sadler and Voss; only Pietrzak was off duty), so the arbitrator's comparability finding misstates the record it rests on. The memorandum also says "The Commonwealth declined prosecution" of an off-duty shooting in the District.
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 9

LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)

My analysis. It's unclear how this rubric got created, since this seems like a straightforward mistake that even a nonlawyer would catch. The rubric rewards models for identifying that the "comparator memorandum's stated coverage years conflict with the dates of the cases it summarizes." But both documents cited as the source for this have the correct dates. The memo says it reviewed

"records covering calendar years 2018 through 2021." It then lists cases from August 2018, November 2019, May 2020, and March 2021, which were resolved in January 2019, June 2020, February 2021, and October 2021, respectively. There is no mismatch, so this rubric would reward models for hallucinating a mismatch that is not present in the environment.

10. Viability of a DCCA Challenge, assignment 2: Scope of Review

criterion `criterion_4`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +26 points.** Identifies that no uploaded authority requires MPD to prove the comparability of its comparator cases.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_4`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Defective: Award ¶ 7 says "Two of the four comparators involved on-duty conduct," but the comparator memorandum shows three on duty (Guzman, Sadler and Voss; only Pietrzak was off duty), so the arbitrator's comparability finding misstates the record it rests on. The memorandum also says "The Commonwealth declined prosecution" of an off-duty shooting in the District.
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 10
LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: met. Result: met (2/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: met. Result: met (3/3)

My analysis. The rubric wants an analysis of an employee disciplinary dispute to make the point that "no uploaded authority requires MPD to prove the comparability of its comparator cases." But *Douglas v. Veterans Administration*, 5 M.S.P.B. 313, 5 M.S.P.R. 280 (1981), one of the uploaded authorities, states that "it should be clear that the ultimate burden is upon the agency to persuade the Board [the Merit Systems Protection Board] of the appropriateness of the penalty imposed." *Id.* at 333. It adds that "[t]he selection of an appropriate penalty is a distinct element of the agency's decision, and therefore properly within its burden of persuasion," and that when the employee "challenges the severity of the penalty," as Braddock did (the stipulated arbitral issue was whether "the penalty of termination [is] appropriate"), "the agency will be called upon to present such further evidence." *Id.* at 334.

That language comes just after a list of 12 factors that prior rulings have identified as relevant for determining the appropriateness of a penalty, which includes (as factor six) "consistency of the penalty with those imposed upon other employees for the same or similar offenses." *Id.* at 332. *Douglas* does note that "Not all of these factors will be pertinent in every case," so there is no bright-line requirement that the agency prove factor six in every case. But *Douglas* makes clear that the burden is on the agency to establish the appropriateness of the penalty and comparability is expressly identified as an important factor in assessing appropriateness.

Critically, in this specific case, MPD's Final Notice of Adverse Action expressly relied on comparable cases as an aggravating factor and a key factor for terminating Officer Braddock. Thus, in the context of this case, the proposition the rubric wants the AI to assert is wrong. If MPD cannot prove to the arbitrator that the comparator officers were similarly situated (as the Final Notice asserts, and as the arbitrator found MPD did not), that could be a basis for at least vacating the termination decision and remanding it for further consideration. Sol and Opus labeled this as an arguable defect, but under the specific circumstances of this case, I would view this assertion as objectively inaccurate. Failure to prove up the comparable cases does not automatically invalidate MPD's action, but it leaves MPD highly vulnerable to being overturned – so in this context, MPD does need to prove the comparable cases that it relied on in making its decision to terminate Braddock.

This rubric appears to be lifted from a real case that matches the fact pattern in the task, *D.C. Metropolitan Police Department v. D.C. Public Employee Relations Board*, 282 A.3d 598 (D.C. 2022), and No. 24-CV-0573 (D.C. May 21, 2026), where MPD explicitly argued that it was not required to put forward comparable cases. But in the real case, the issue was that MPD had not identified any comparable cases where termination was the discipline imposed, and the terminated officer's union came forward with cases involving comparable conduct where the punishment was less severe. The task environment here was modified from the real case, so that in this fictional universe, MPD itself puts comparable cases at issue in its initial decision terminating the officer. In that context, the argument advanced in the real case no longer holds and the rubric is incorrect because it fails to take into account how this task environment was modified from the real case. The rubric is essentially importing a proposition of law from the real case without recognizing that the task environment was changed in a way that makes that proposition irrelevant on the facts being presented to the model.

11. Viability of a DCCA Challenge, assignment 3: Statutory Exceptions

criterion `criterion_16`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +6 points.** Identifies that the PERB Decision misstates the length of the suspension imposed by the Award.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_16`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Not defective
Task environment	Defective: Award ¶ 7 says "Two of the four comparators involved on-duty conduct," but the comparator memorandum shows three on duty (Guzman, Sadler and Voss; only Pietrzak was off duty), so the arbitrator's comparability finding misstates the record it rests on. The memorandum also says "The Commonwealth declined prosecution" of an off-duty shooting in the District.
AI auditors' reasoning	Wrong
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 11

LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: met. Result: met (3/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: met. Result: met (3/3)

My analysis. Rubric is correct. The rubric wants an internal memorandum to point out that the D.C. Public Employee Relations Board's decision incorrectly states that the officer was suspended for 40 days, when in fact the suspension was 45 days.

Sol's point is that the prompt did not specifically request that analysis. But the prompt directs the associate to "[a]nchor each argument in specific findings of the Award and the PERB Decision," and a careful lawyer doing that would notice that the decision misstates the penalty it affirmed "in all respects." While I agree that it is not necessarily essential for a memo to call out what appears to be a typo in the Board's decision, doing so does improve an internal memo – and this is a situation where it would be desirable to train models to flag that discrepancy even if the user did not specifically prompt for it. The misstatement of fact in the Board's decision affirming the arbitration award is important information for the lawyer to be aware of, and a lawyer using AI to prepare this memo might not think to ask specifically about those kinds of discrepancies. So the rubric is a desirable training signal, and to the extent it asks the model to go somewhat beyond the prompt, this specific example is a good instance where you clearly would want the model to flag an issue that you might not have thought to ask about in your prompt.

12. Plaintiff's Response - Forum Non Conveniens, assignment 1

criterion `criterion_2`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +5 points.** Identifies in Assignment #1 an affidavit by John Smith, M.D. does not indicate that Cook County would be an inconvenient forum for him to litigate this case as required under Langenhorst v. Norfolk S. Ry. Co., 219 Ill. 2d 430 (Ill. 2006).
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_2`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Not defective
Task environment	Defective: The partner's email says Baby Davis was transferred to "Lurie's Children's Hospital" and "almost passed away on September 16, 2024," but the Complaint says he was transferred to and died at Cook County Hospital (¶¶ 27, 29). The defendants' filed affidavits also carry unfilled placeholders: Dr. Smith's affidavit gives his residence and office as "[street address], [city]" (Ex. A ¶¶ 2–3), and the hospital's affiant is named only as "[Records Custodian]" (Ex. B).
AI auditors' reasoning	Wrong
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 12

LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (1/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: met. Result: met (3/3)

My analysis. Rubric is correct as written. The case involves a request by defendants to move a case from Cook County (where Chicago is located) to DuPage County (a bordering county immediately west of Cook County, with Chicago O'Hare airport extending partially into DuPage County). One of the defendants, Dr. John Smith, submitted an affidavit arguing that DuPage County is more

convenient than Cook County, but it does not expressly state that Cook County is "inconvenient." The rubric wants a memo analyzing the issue to point out that Dr. Smith does not state in his affidavit that it would be inconvenient for him to litigate in Cook County.

Sol initially flagged the criterion as arguable, reasoning that because Dr. Smith swears DuPage would be "substantially more convenient" than Cook, "[a] careful reviewer could reasonably treat that as comparative inconvenience." But the rubric is correct because it's pointing out that the standard isn't which location is "more" convenient; a defendant seeking to move on forum non conveniens grounds needs to establish that the plaintiff's chosen forum is actually inconvenient to the defendant.

The task environment contains a decision, *Langenhorst v. Norfolk Southern Railway Co.*, 219 Ill. 2d 430, 848 N.E.2d 927 (2006), that states the rule drawing this distinction between an argument that another location would be "more" convenient for one party and proof that the plaintiff's chosen location is actually inconvenient: "The defendant must show that the plaintiff's chosen forum is inconvenient to the defendant and that another forum is more convenient to all parties." 219 Ill. 2d at 444. So Sol's point is not well taken in this instance. The later reconciliation overturned Sol's flag on this ground.

13. Plaintiff's Response - Forum Non Conveniens, assignment 1

criterion `criterion_22`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Penalty criterion, −30 points.** Mentions in Assignment #1 that Cook County lacks interest in adjudicating a controversy over care rendered by its DuPage based providers.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_22`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — professional judgment; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Defective: The partner's email says Baby Davis was transferred to "Lurie's Children's Hospital" and "almost passed away on September 16, 2024," but the Complaint says he was transferred to and died at Cook County Hospital (¶¶ 27, 29). The defendants' filed affidavits also carry unfilled placeholders: Dr. Smith's affidavit gives his residence and office as "[street address], [city]" (Ex. A ¶¶ 2–3), and the hospital's affiant is named only as "[Records Custodian]" (Ex. B).
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 13
LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: clear; Claude Sonnet 5: clear; Gemini 3.8 Flash: clear. Result: penalty not applied (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: clear; Claude Sonnet 5: clear; Gemini 3.8 Flash: clear. Result: penalty not applied (0/3)

My analysis. The rubric penalizes a memo that "Mentions . . . that Cook County lacks interest in adjudicating a controversy over care rendered by its DuPage based providers." The rubric is subtly misspecified in a way that can affect the grading. The reason the rubric is penalizing a memo that raises this point is that the environment contains a case, *Bradbury v. St. Mary's Hospital*

of Kankakee, 273 Ill. App. 3d 555, 652 N.E.2d 1228 (1st Dist. 1995), that indicates that Cook County has an interest in situations like these if the patient died there – and the case at issue in the environment involves a patient death, so the theory underlying the rubric is sound.

However, the defendants do argue in their motion that Cook County has limited interest in the death – and as written the rubric penalizes any memo that even "mentions" that Cook County lacks interest. So a grader could apply this penalty even to a memo that simply "mentions" the defendants' argument and then correctly explains why it's wrong under *Bradbury*.

In our test runs, the judges did not impose the penalty for this specific rubric, but penalties were triggered improperly on other rubrics that used the same "Mentions" format, such as criterion 25 ("Mentions in Assignment #1 that Cook County's overall clearance rate is 60.5%," -30), where all judges penalized the models for correctly raising an opponent's argument and rebutting it.

14. Plaintiff's Response - Forum Non Conveniens, assignment 2

criterion `criterion_1`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +3 points.** States in Assignment #2 that the response is supported by the affidavit of Liam Vance, a physician who provided care to Baby Davis at Cook County Hospital.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_1`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — professional judgment; arises from the task environment
Task environment	Defective: No affidavit from any of the five physicians is provided in the environment, and the prompt does not explicitly instruct the model to create one. The prompt also says, "If a document is not uploaded, it does not exist for purposes of this analysis."
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 14

LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: met. Result: met (3/3)

My analysis. The rubric wants the plaintiff's opposition brief (in response to defendants' forum non conveniens motion) to state that the plaintiff's "response is supported by the affidavit of Liam Vance, a physician who provided care to Baby Davis at Cook County Hospital." But no such affidavit is provided in the environment, and the prompt does not explicitly instruct the model to create it. The prompt further says "Do not rely on, reference, or infer any legal authority, factual information, or data beyond what is contained in these uploaded files. If a document is not uploaded, it does not exist for purposes of this analysis." While the prompt elsewhere says, "Please include all affidavits and information you referenced from Assignment #1," that suggests the model should "include" documents that were referenced in the environment, not generate new ones or assume that they will be created separately. Although the assignment 1 rubric rewards recommending that the plaintiff obtain affidavits from these physicians, and the assignment 2 prompt asks the model to include

the affidavits referenced in assignment 1, I would still consider drafting a brief that assumes what third-party witnesses will sign to be hazardous and unreliable.

Drafting an opposition brief that cites to affidavits (without placeholders in the draft) is extremely hazardous behavior to train models on in a legal setting. In a real run, Opus was rewarded for drafting affidavits and including in the brief citations to them without placeholders, while Luna did not create the affidavits or cite to them. If forced to choose, I would consider Luna's approach more correct in this instance, as a matter of professional judgment. Although Luna's approach suffered from its own flaws (including that it incorrectly said the record does not reflect the physicians' willingness to testify), I would prefer the approach of not citing affidavits that don't yet exist.

The contemplated affidavits are from nonparty physicians that the case team does not represent; while it is helpful that a lawyer on the case team spoke to these witnesses and obtained an understanding of their views that can be turned into a draft affidavit, ultimately a nonparty is entitled to decide exactly what it is willing to affirm in writing and a lawyer cannot simply assume that the witness will be willing to sign an affidavit based on the lawyer's understanding from an initial call. The normal approach in a situation like this would be to draft placeholder citations to an affidavit that make clear the language must be adjusted to conform to the witness's final testimony. Opus's draft affidavit includes one form for five physicians, and in practice, I would expect the physicians to object to some of what is included in the affidavit (and in fact getting all five to actually sign these affidavits in time would be a fairly significant undertaking, so I would not assume all five affidavits ultimately enter into the record as this assignment contemplates). The Opus work product creates a real risk that a human lawyer, through inadvertence or mistake, might file a brief that claims to be supported by affidavits that have not in fact been sworn, which is a serious ethical lapse.

Overall, the practical effect of this rubric seems to be to nudge the model in the direction of thinking it is OK to invent witness testimony that has not yet been approved by a witness. The issue could be avoided either by including an actual affidavit approved by the witness in the environment or asking the model to merely include bracketed text/placeholders that are clearly labeled as draft so that the draft is clear and explicit that the affidavits are contemplated or expected, rather than already secured, as Opus's draft of the brief implies.

This issue is distinct from items 7 and 8, where my view was that it was appropriate for a model to refer in a brief to expert analysis that was referred to in the environment but not supplied. In that case, we had clear indications that the expert analysis described really existed; the full details were simply not provided in the model prompt, so it is important to flag the existence of that evidence apparently already present in the record. Here, the environment makes clear that, for purposes of this assignment, the affidavits do not exist, yet the rubric rewards a model for creating a draft that could easily be filed mistakenly with the false assertion that these doctors have provided affidavits to support their views (which may or may not ultimately come to pass).

15. Plaintiff's Response - Forum Non Conveniens, assignment 2

criterion `criterion_11`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +5 points.** States in Assignment #2 that the response is supported by the affidavit of the plaintiff, Sara Davis.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_11`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — professional judgment; arises from the task environment
Task environment	Defective: No affidavit from Sara Davis is provided in the environment, and the prompt does not explicitly instruct the model to create one. The only fact supplied about her circumstances is that she "resides in Kane County, Illinois."
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 15
LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: met. Result: met (2/3)

My analysis. This has the same problem as item 14 of asking the model to draft (apparently without placeholders) an assertion that a given point is supported by an affidavit that does not exist. This one is a closer call because the affiant is the client, so the lawyers preparing this opposition brief presumably can be more confident in what the client's testimony will be. But even a client needs to be comfortable that the facts they are swearing to are accurate and may tell the lawyer to change them, so preparing a complete sworn affidavit containing facts found nowhere in the record, and citing it in the brief as sworn fact, as Opus has done (and was fully rewarded for, on a 2–1 vote), is still hazardous.

There is a separate issue here where Sonnet misgraded the rubric because it refers to Assignment #2 in the actual rubric text that is supplied to the judge model, but that is a reference to the prompt the generative models receive and should not be in the output. Sonnet did the same thing on three other criteria in this run (criteria 4, 5 and 22), failing the brief only because it had no "Assignment #2" label; in each case the other two judges passed it, so the majority result did not change. For purposes of this exercise, I am not treating that as a rubric defect because all the rubrics in the land-use and forum non conveniens matters have the issue that they refer to a specific assignment number that is not legible to the judge grader. That is an overarching issue in the benchmark setup that can be addressed globally.

16. Plaintiff's Response - Forum Non Conveniens, assignment 2

criterion `criterion_18`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Penalty criterion, −30 points.** States in Assignment #2 that the 2023 Illinois Annual Report Statistics report a 60.5% clearance rate in Cook County, Illinois.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_18`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — professional judgment; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Defective: No affidavit from any of the five physicians or from Sara Davis is provided in the environment, and the prompt does not explicitly instruct the model to create one. The prompt also says, "If a document is not uploaded, it does not exist for purposes of this analysis."
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 16
LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: fires; Claude Sonnet 5: fires; Gemini 3.8 Flash: fires. Result: penalty applied (3/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: fires; Claude Sonnet 5: fires; Gemini 3.8 Flash: fires. Result: penalty applied (3/3)

My analysis. The rubric penalizes models for stating that the 2023 Illinois Annual Report Statistics report a 60.5% clearance rate in Cook County, Illinois. But that document is provided in the environment and does indeed report the rate given as the clearance rate for all cases. In our test runs, Opus and Luna were both penalized incorrectly for noting this figure while explaining why it deserved little weight: Opus contrasted it with the civil-case rates (97.9% and 96.3%), and Luna said it "expressly covers all case types." While some lawyers prefer not to raise bad facts that the other side has not raised, here, the defendants' opening brief squarely presents the 60.5% statistic to the Court – so any competent opposition would respond to that argument. There is no reason to penalize a model for doing so.

17. Plaintiff's Response - Forum Non Conveniens, assignment 2

criterion `criterion_3`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +3 points.** States in Assignment #2 that the response is supported by the affidavit of Caleb Montgomery, a physician who provided care to Baby Davis at Cook County Hospital.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_3`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — professional judgment; arises from the task environment
Task environment	Defective: No affidavit from any of the five physicians is provided in the environment, and the prompt does not explicitly instruct the model to create one. The prompt also says, "If a document is not uploaded, it does not exist for purposes of this analysis."
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 17
LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: met. Result: met (3/3)

My analysis. Same issue as item 14. The criterion rewards a brief for saying the response is supported by an affidavit that does not exist in the environment (and which the model is not instructed to create). This is one of several rubrics we deemed defective for encouraging models to cite to affidavits that do not exist or have not been settled/signed by the third party witnesses whose views they purport to represent (14, 15 and 17–20).

18. Plaintiff's Response - Forum Non Conveniens, assignment 2

criterion `criterion_6`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +3 points.** Identifies in Assignment #2 that the affidavit by Liam Vance indicates that DuPage County would be an inconvenient forum for him to litigate this case as required under Langenhorst v. Norfolk S. Ry. Co. 219 Ill. 2d 430 (Ill. 2006).
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_6`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — professional judgment; arises from the task environment
Task environment	Defective: No affidavit from any of the five physicians is provided in the environment, and the prompt does not explicitly instruct the model to create one. The prompt also says, "If a document is not uploaded, it does not exist for purposes of this analysis."
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 18
LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: met. Result: met (3/3)

My analysis. Same issue as item 14. The criterion rewards a brief for saying an affidavit that does not exist in the environment (and which the model is not instructed to create) shows that DuPage County would be an inconvenient forum. This is one of several rubrics we deemed defective for encouraging models to cite to affidavits that do not exist or have not been settled/signed by the

third party witnesses whose views they purport to represent (14, 15 and 17–20).

19. Plaintiff's Response - Forum Non Conveniens, assignment 2

criterion `criterion_8`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +3 points.** Identifies in Assignment #2 that the affidavit by Caleb Montgomery indicates that DuPage County would be an inconvenient forum for him to litigate this case as required under Langenhorst v. Norfolk S. Ry. Co. 219 Ill. 2d 430 (Ill. 2006).
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_8`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — professional judgment; arises from the task environment
Task environment	Defective: No affidavit from any of the five physicians is provided in the environment, and the prompt does not explicitly instruct the model to create one. The prompt also says, "If a document is not uploaded, it does not exist for purposes of this analysis."
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 19

LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: met. Result: met (3/3)

My analysis. Same issue as item 14. The criterion rewards a brief for saying an affidavit that does not exist in the environment (and which the model is not instructed to create) shows that DuPage County would be an inconvenient forum. This is one of several rubrics we deemed defective for encouraging models to cite to affidavits that do not exist or have not been settled/signed by the third party witnesses whose views they purport to represent (14, 15 and 17–20).

20. Plaintiff's Response - Forum Non Conveniens, assignment 2

criterion `criterion_9`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +3 points.** Identifies in Assignment #2 that the affidavit by Maya Linwood indicates that DuPage County would be an inconvenient forum for her to litigate this case as required under Langenhorst v. Norfolk S. Ry. Co. 219 Ill. 2d 430 (Ill. 2006).
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_9`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — professional judgment; arises from the task environment
Task environment	Defective: No affidavit from any of the five physicians is provided in the environment, and the prompt does not explicitly instruct the model to create one. The prompt also says, "If a document is not uploaded, it does not exist for purposes of this analysis."
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 20
LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: met. Result: met (3/3)

My analysis. Same issue as item 14. The criterion rewards a brief for saying an affidavit that does not exist in the environment (and which the model is not instructed to create) shows that DuPage County would be an inconvenient forum. This is one of several rubrics we deemed defective for encouraging models to cite to affidavits that do not exist or have not been settled/signed by the third party witnesses whose views they purport to represent (14, 15 and 17–20).

21. OTB Gang VICAR Trial Jury Instructions, assignment 1: Appeal brief re: justification instruction

criterion `criterion_21`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +15 points.** States that Patton's commission of conspiracy to commit a forcible felony precludes a justification defense.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_21`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 21
LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: met. Result: met (3/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: met. Result: met (3/3)

My analysis. The rubric rewards models for a legal error. The case involves federal charges against a gang member who shot at a rival gang member after following him from a mall. The defendant pled guilty to state charges of conspiracy to commit a forcible felony in connection with the incident. The rubric wants the prosecution's brief to argue that the commission of conspiracy to commit a forcible felony precludes the justification (self-defense) defense, under Iowa Code 704.6.

But that statute only applies when the defendant commits a different forcible felony than the one

he is alleging is justified. The paradigmatic case would be a robber who waves a hammer at a store clerk to take the cash in the register, intending only to frighten the clerk, and who cannot claim self-defense if the clerk responds by shooting at him (robbery is a forcible felony under the supplied Iowa Code § 702.11(1)). Iowa courts apply the bar in that setting. *See State v. Roby*, No. 22-1017, slip op. at 8 (Iowa Ct. App. Sept. 27, 2023) (defendant who brought a gun to an apartment and shot an occupant who drew his own weapon: "A justification defense was unavailable to Roby because he was participating in the forcible felony of robbery. See Iowa Code § 704.6(1).").

Here, the defendant is arguing that the shooting itself was an act of self-defense; there is no contention that he was committing a different forcible felony prior to the shooting that would negate his ability to claim self-defense for the shooting itself. (Although we did not find an Iowa case expressly holding that the forcible felony must be independent of the act claimed to be justified, judges in at least one other state with a similar statute have expressly held this. *See Martinez v. State*, 981 So. 2d 449 (Fla. 2008) (holding that for the forcible-felony bar to apply, "there must be an independent forcible felony other than the one which the defendant claims he or she committed in self-defense"). Obviously, the law could not be to the contrary because, if it were, the exception would swallow the rule; self-defense would never be available, because absent the defense, the use of force would almost always constitute a forcible felony.)

This environment is based on a real case, and in the real case, neither the Eighth Circuit nor the government's brief opposing certiorari relied on the argument (that the rubric requires) that the conspiracy to commit a forcible felony precludes the justification defense. Instead, the government argued that the defendant as a felon in possession had a duty to retreat safely and could have done so instead of shooting as he did. The evidence indicates this was a scenario where two rival gangs were actively seeking opportunities to shoot members of the other, not that an innocent person was attacked and then defended themselves.

22. OTB Gang VICAR Trial Jury Instructions, assignment 1: Appeal brief re: justification instruction

criterion `criterion_23`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Penalty criterion, −5 points.** Mentions that Patton pled guilty in state court to intimidation with a dangerous weapon.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_23`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — professional judgment; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 22

LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: clear; Claude Sonnet 5: clear; Gemini 3.8 Flash: clear. Result: penalty not applied (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: fires; Claude Sonnet 5: fires; Gemini 3.8 Flash: clear. Result: penalty applied (2/3)

My analysis. The rubric penalizes mentioning that Patton pled guilty in state court to intimidation

with a dangerous weapon, because that incident relates to a different event than the one at issue on his appeal. The rubric seems intended to test the model's ability to distinguish the events and understand that the earlier incident is unrelated. However, it is misspecified because it penalizes any mention of the issue. Opus was penalized merely for including a drafting note that flagged for the attorney that it had decided *not* to rely on the other incident because it was unrelated. A brief or drafting note that mentions the April 13 plea only to set it aside is correct work, so I do not think penalizing a model for merely mentioning it is correct. (The Count XX plea petition is dated November 18, 2020, after the May 10, 2020 shooting, so it is not a prior conviction.)

23. OTB Gang VICAR Trial Jury Instructions, assignment 2: Supplementing brief with new case

criterion `criterion_4`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +25 points.** Mentions that there was a lack of evidence proving who fired first on May 10, 2020.
>
> — micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_4`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — unambiguous objective error; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 23

LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)

My analysis. This is another instance where the task environment differs from the real-world case on which it is based in a way that is material to this specific rubric – and a rubric that would be correct for the real-world case is incorrectly applied to this task environment. In the real case, *United States v. Mallory*, 104 F.4th 15 (8th Cir. 2024), there was a dispute concerning who fired first. This task environment was "closed book," however, and the model was given a statement of facts that says that Raysean Nelson "opened fire as the Trailblazer approached" and that "A rolling gun battle ensued." So there is no basis in the supplied environment for the model to assert that there was a lack of evidence concerning who fired first; the supplied documents state that Nelson did so. The supplied facts are internally consistent; the error is the rubric's failure to follow the task's own changes to the real case.

24. OTB Gang VICAR Trial Jury Instructions, assignment 2: Supplementing brief with new case

criterion `criterion_7`

> Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench
>
> **Reward criterion, +10 points.** Mentions that Nelson's car was already stopped

when Patton fired his gun.

— micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_7`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — professional judgment; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 24
LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)

My analysis. This benchmark does two assignments, sequentially, in separate model sessions that are in the same sandbox. In this task, assignment 2 was to build on the assignment 1 output by adding discussion of an additional case. The intent is for models to output response1.md in response to assignment 1, and to output response2.md in the same sandbox for assignment 2.

The model is told, "Build on [the assignment 1] analysis as the prompt directs," but not clearly told that it is expected to output a full revised version of the brief (as opposed to supplemental or revised sections that can be inserted into a revised brief). Since assignment 2 is framed as a mere supplementation task, the model might expect that it should write only the new material.

However, five of the assignment 1 rubrics are repeated on the assignment 2 output – so a model is penalized heavily if it interprets the instructions as requesting simply an update to the specific section to which the new authority is relevant. In effect, the rubric is testing for one particular response to somewhat ambiguous instructions. This rewards work beyond the scope the prompt states, and a complete revised brief is not what the prompt clearly requests.

25. OTB Gang VICAR Trial Jury Instructions, assignment 2: Supplementing brief with new case

criterion `criterion_8`

Quoted from micro1 LegalReasonBench

Reward criterion, +15 points. States that the OTB group could have driven away.

— micro1 LegalReasonBench, `criterion_8`, rubric at revision `1bfa904c`

My assessment	
Criterion	Defective — professional judgment; does not arise from the task environment
Task environment	Correct
AI auditors' reasoning	Correct
Sources and run details	Review worksheet, item 25
LegalReasonBench's own grading of two model runs (its judges, not my assessment)	
GPT-6 Luna (xhigh)	GPT-5.6 Terra: not met; Claude Sonnet 5: not met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: not met (0/3)
Claude Opus 5.5 (low)	GPT-5.6 Terra: met; Claude Sonnet 5: met; Gemini 3.8 Flash: not met. Result: met (2/3)

My analysis. This benchmark does two assignments, sequentially, in separate model sessions that are in the same sandbox. In this task, assignment 2 was to build on the assignment 1 output by adding discussion of an additional case. The intent is for models to output response1.md in response to assignment 1, and to output response2.md in the same sandbox for assignment 2.

The model is told, "Build on [the assignment 1] analysis as the prompt directs," but not clearly told that it is expected to output a full revised version of the brief (as opposed to supplemental or revised sections that can be inserted into a revised brief). Since assignment 2 is framed as a mere supplementation task, the model might expect that it should write only the new material.

However, five of the assignment 1 rubrics are repeated on the assignment 2 output – so a model is penalized heavily if it interprets the instructions as requesting simply an update to the specific section to which the new authority is relevant. In effect, the rubric is testing for one particular response to somewhat ambiguous instructions. This rewards work beyond the scope the prompt states, and a complete revised brief is not what the prompt clearly requests.